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Scrum Product Owner Certification

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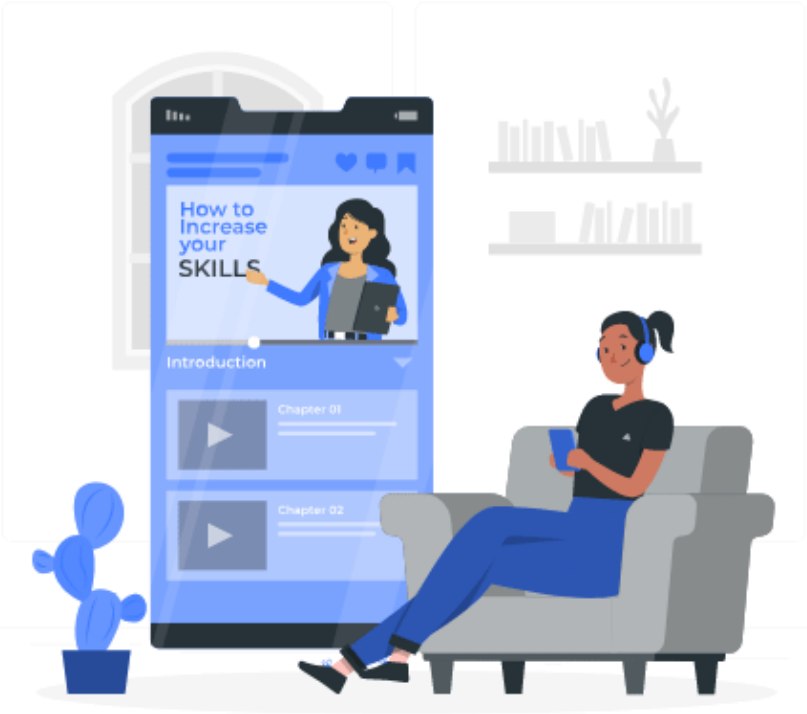

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Module 1: Introduction to Scrum

- ✓ What is Scrum?
- ✓ Benefits of SCRUM
- ✓ What is the Core Concept of Scrum?
- ✓ How can Scrum Provide Value into the Organisation?
- ✓ Scrum Process Diagram
- ✓ Scrum Flow
- ✓ Core Components of the Framework
- ✓ Understand the Principles of Empirical Process Control

What is Scrum – The Big Picture?

Scrum (n): A framework within which people can address complex adaptive problems, while productively and creatively delivering products of the highest possible value

Scrum is:

- ✓ Lightweight
- ✓ Simple to understand
- ✓ Difficult to master

What is Scrum – The Big Picture?

- ✓ Scrum is an agile process that allows users to focus on delivering the highest business value in the shortest time
- ✓ It allows practitioners to inspect actual working software (every two weeks to one month), and decide whether to release as is or continue on another program of enhancement (sprint)
- ✓ The business sets the priorities, with teams determining themselves the best way to deliver the highest priority features

Benefits of SCRUM

The features of Scrum lead to the following benefits:

1. Project can respond easily to change
2. Inspects and adapts
3. Problems are identified early
4. Low bureaucratic overhead
5. Customer gets most beneficial work first
6. Work done will better meet the customers needs

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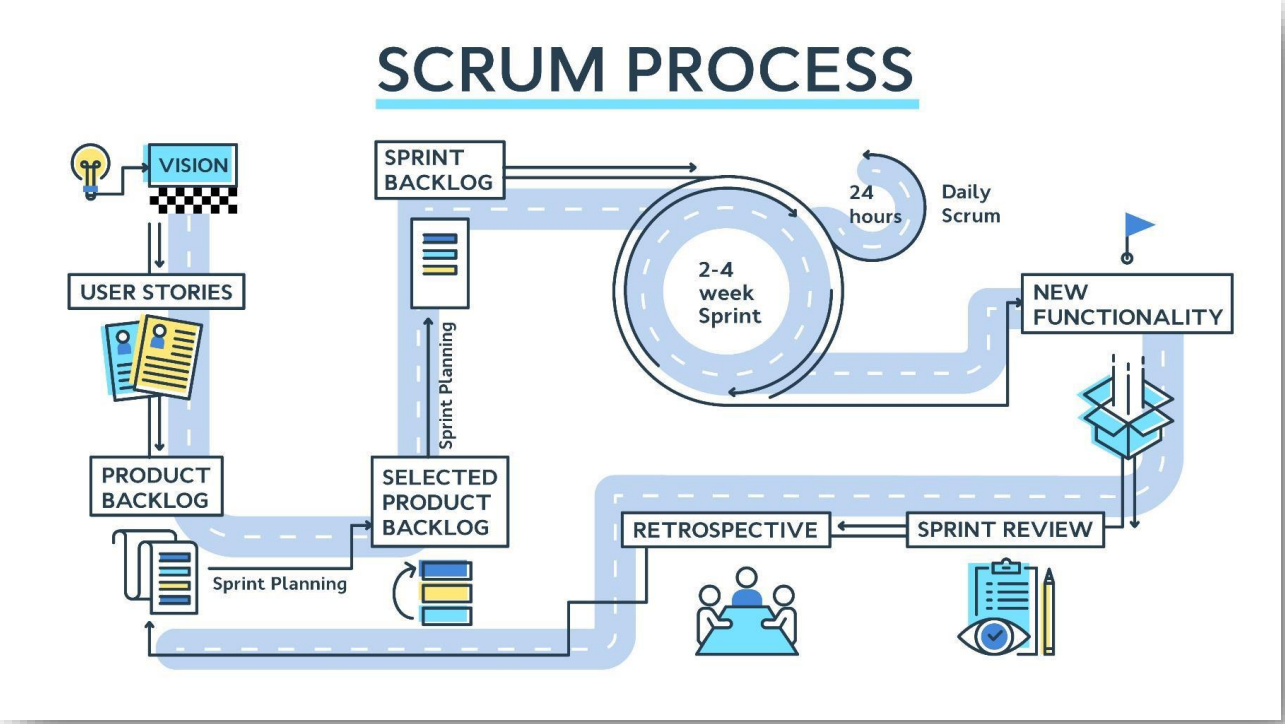
What is the Core Concept of Scrum?

The Scrum process consists of several steps that can be seen below. The elements of this process will be explained in more detail throughout the course



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How can Scrum Provide Value into the Organisation?

Courage, focus, commitment, respect, and openness are excellent qualities for any workplace, especially if you are not working in a Scrum environment. So, how can you enforce Scrum values like these in the workplace?

It is impossible to uphold those principles on a regular basis as the team leader or project manager, whether you are or are not

- ✓ Accept difficult challenges to show your bravery
- ✓ Display emphasis by adhering to the schedule
- ✓ Engagement is demonstrated by doing your job well and believing in your partner
- ✓ Encourage team members to do their work independently to support them

How can Scrum Provide Value into the Organisation?

- ✓ Create honesty by recognising failures and discussing opportunities for change with the team in a straightforward and respectful manner
- ✓ Consider exploiting can technologies. There are numerous automated project management solutions available, but they do not always adhere to Scrum principles
- ✓ Look for a forum that encourages team members to work individually (commitment and respect), rather than complicating collaboration

How can Scrum Provide Value into the Organisation?

The 5 Scrum Values

- ✓ Scrum is based on five values that each team member uses to guide decision-making. They had now entered the well-known framework of common sense
- ✓ However, because they are essential to the practical completion of Scrum, they must be addressed here:

01	02	03	04	05
Courage	Focus	Openness	Commitment	Respect

How can Scrum Provide Value into the Organisation?

1. Courage:

The Scrum Team members are confident in their ability to do the right thing and focus on important issues. The team members help one another by doing the correct thing and taking calculated chances so that we can enhance and learn on our journey to be better

2. Focus

A Sprint in Scrum is a four-week period during which the team works on a specific set of goals. Focusing on a Scrum Team ensures that each person sets aside pet projects during a Sprint, avoiding the temptation to either work ahead or go back and retouch other activities. To achieve the team's goals, each member of the team must concentrate on the tasks specified in the Sprint Plan

3. Openness

Every aspect of your business, as well as every other location, is available and open for review and improvement.

How can Scrum Provide Value into the Organisation?

4. Commitment

Scrum team members must be committed to progress and capable of setting and sticking to realistic goals. — The scrum job is dedicated to the team's progress, not just thinking about our successes, but also to creating an atmosphere of confidence, constructive problem-solving, and high team expectations through:

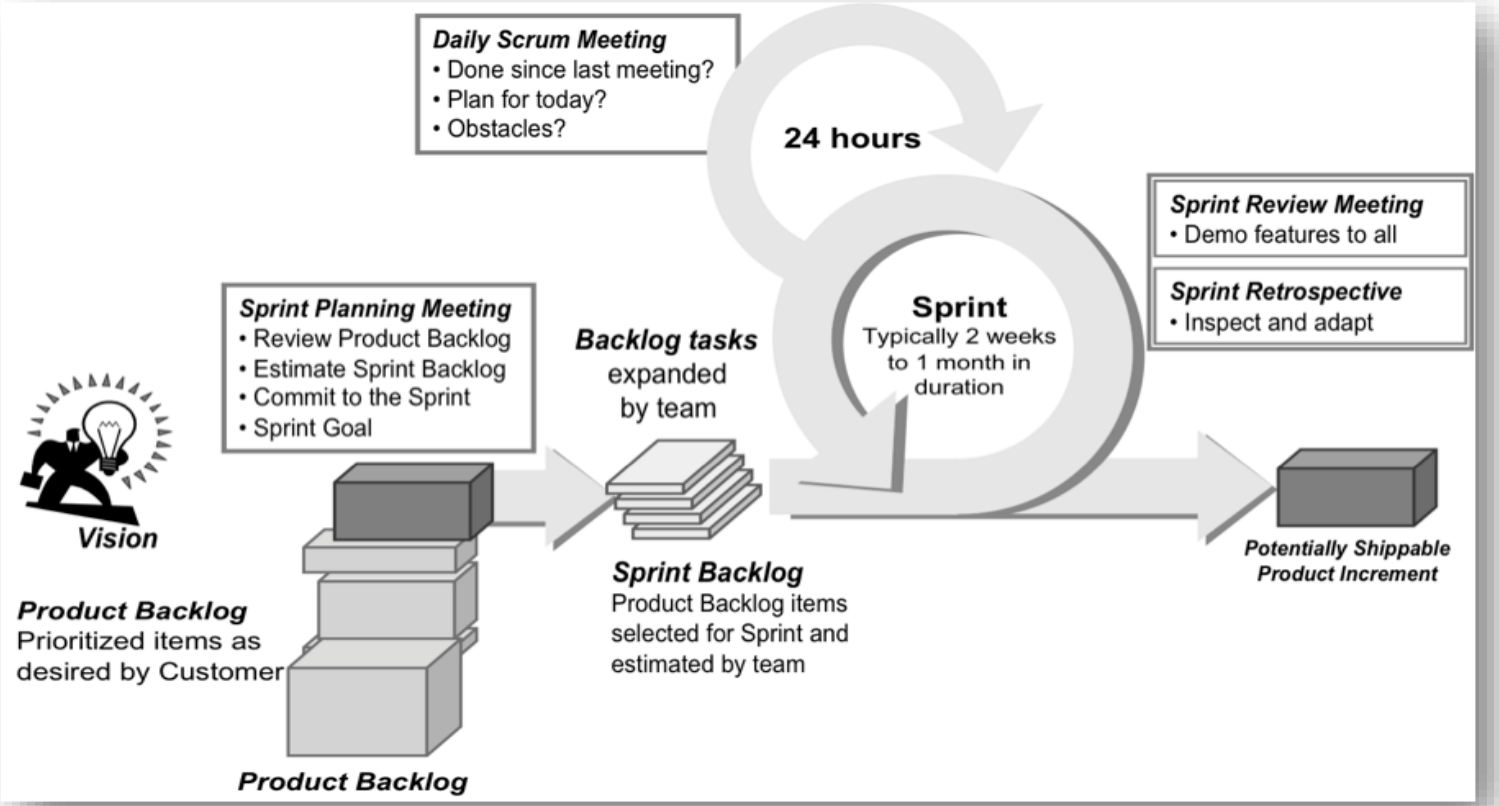
- ✓ The Product Owner shows dedication by making the best decisions to maximise product value rather than simply appeasing any stakeholder.
- ✓ The Scrum Master displays dedication by adhering to the Scrum Structure, which assures that we do not stretch the Sprint or other time-boxes to get to "Done" under pressure.
- ✓ Instead of accepting the status quo within the organisation, the Scrum Master displays dedication by removing impediments that cannot be overcome by the Scrum Team.

How can Scrum Provide Value into the Organisation?

5. Respect

Each part of the team is chosen for their strengths; flaws and opportunities to improve and develop come with them. Harmony is generated by coordinating each position and, as a result, maintaining a growth rhythm as the project progresses. When one person or another is out of touch for an extended period of time, because you are held accountable as a team, supporting that person is in your best financial interest.

Scrum Process Diagram



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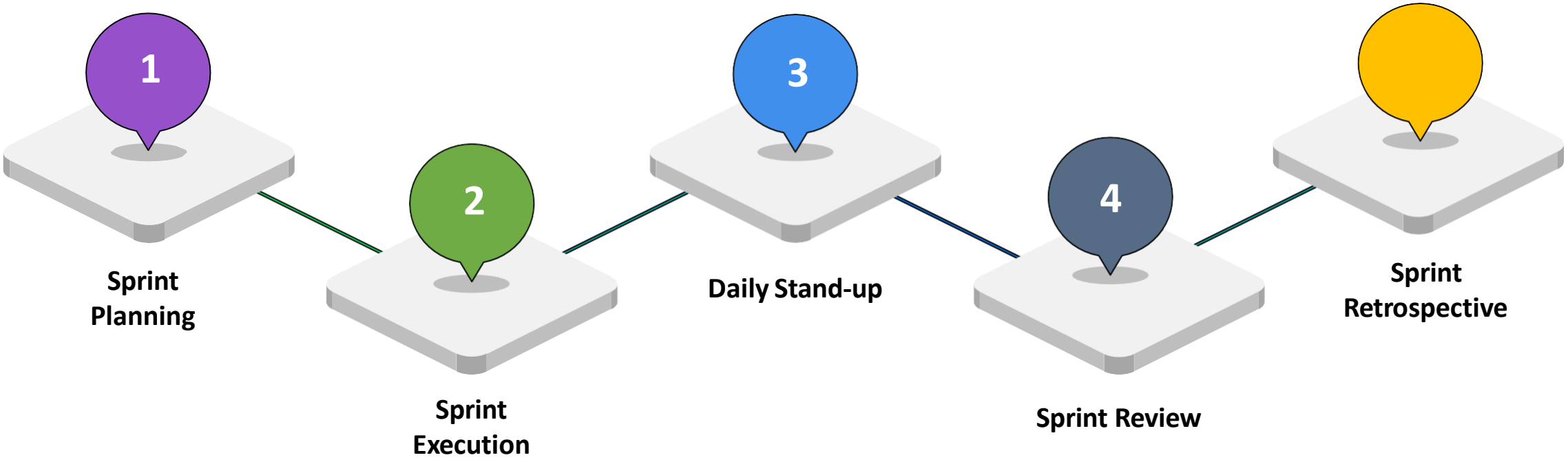
Scrum Flow

Here is a brief overview of the Scrum flow:



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How can Scrum Provide Value into the Organisation?

1. Sprint Planning

In this phase, you collaborate with the Scrum team to define the product backlog items that will be completed during the sprint. As a Product Owner, you provide guidance on the priority of items, clarify the acceptance criteria and answer questions that the team may have about the product backlog items.

2. Sprint Execution

During this phase, the team will work on completing the product backlog items that were identified during the sprint planning. Your role as the Product Owner is to be available to answer any questions that may arise during the sprint, to accept or reject completed work, and to adjust the product backlog as needed.

3. Daily Standup

In this phase, you participate in the daily standup with the Scrum team to provide updates on the product backlog items and address any concerns that the team may have.

How can Scrum Provide Value into the Organisation?

4. Sprint Review

At the end of each sprint, a sprint review is conducted to demonstrate the completed work to stakeholders and receive feedback. As the Product Owner, you will review the completed work and provide feedback to the team to help them improve the product.

5. Sprint Retrospective

In this phase, the team reflects on the previous sprint to identify ways to improve their processes and work more efficiently. You will participate in the retrospective to provide feedback and identify ways to improve the product backlog and prioritise items better.

Core Components of the Framework

The Scrum framework has three core components:

01 Scrum Team

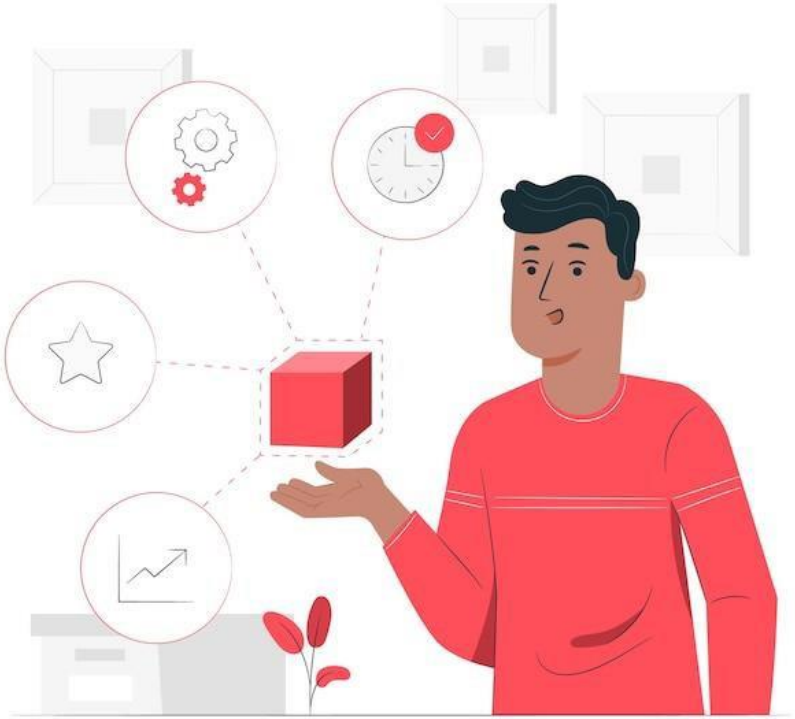
The Scrum team is composed of three roles: the Product Owner, the Scrum Master, and the Development Team. As the Product Owner, you work closely with the Development Team to define and prioritise items on the Product Backlog. You also collaborate with the Scrum Master to ensure that the team is following the Scrum framework and that any impediments to progress are resolved.

Core Components of the Framework

The Scrum framework has three core components:

02 Product Backlog

The Product Backlog is a prioritised list of all the features, functionalities, and requirements that are needed to create a successful product. As the Product Owner, you are responsible for managing the Product Backlog and ensuring that it is constantly refined and updated. You also work with the Development Team to break down large items into smaller, more manageable ones, and ensure that each item is clearly defined and has well-defined acceptance criteria.



Core Components of the Framework

The Scrum framework has three core components:

03 Sprint

The Sprint is a time-boxed period of 2-4 weeks during which the Development Team works on delivering a potentially shippable product increment. As the Product Owner, you collaborate with the Development Team to define the Sprint Goal, which is a short statement that describes the objective of the Sprint. You also prioritise the items on the Product Backlog that will be included in the Sprint, based on the Sprint Goal.

Understand the Principles of Empirical Process Control

- ✓ The principles of empirical process control are a fundamental aspect of the Scrum framework, and as a Scrum Product Owner, it is essential to understand these principles to effectively manage the product backlog and work with the development team.

The three principles of empirical process control in Scrum:

1. Transparency

We all know what is going on

2. Adaptation

OK to change tactical direction

3. Inspection

Check your work as you do it

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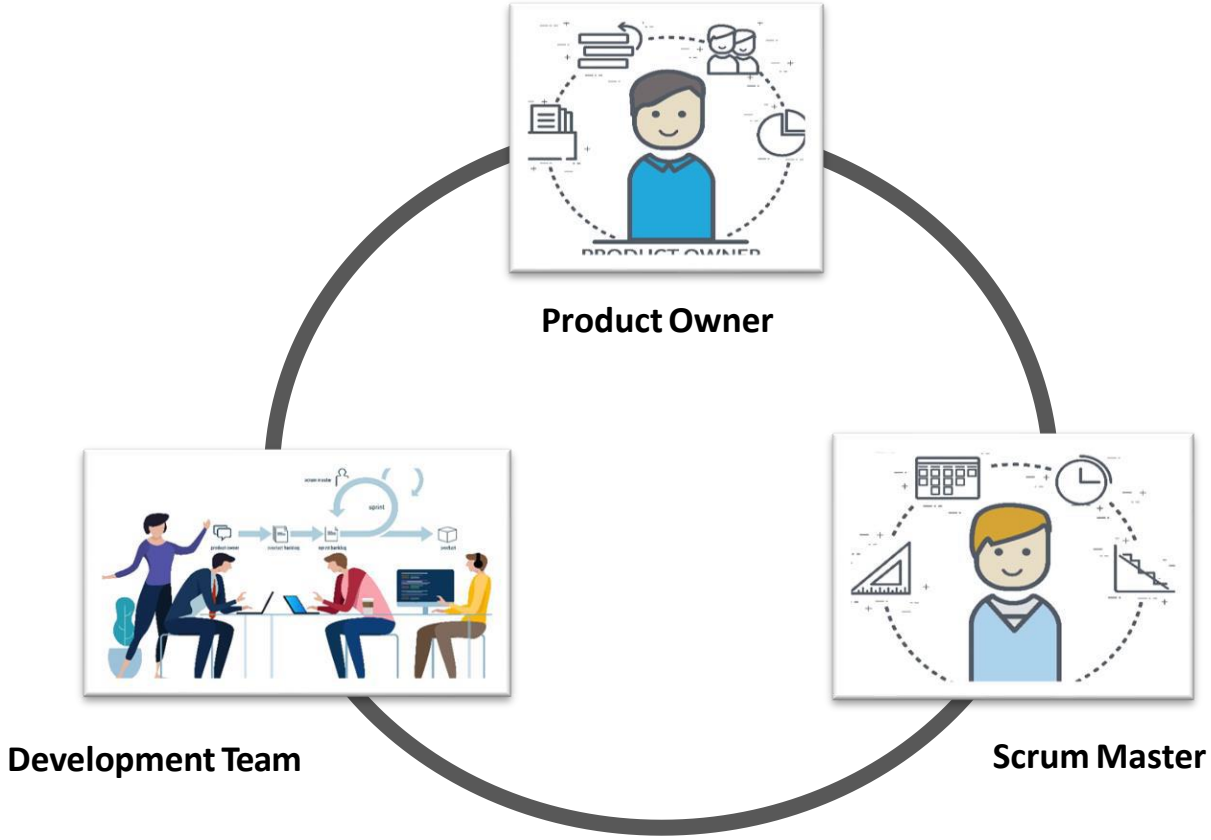
Module 2: Scrum Roles and Responsibilities

- ✓ The Scrum Team
- ✓ Product Owner
- ✓ Scrum Master
- ✓ Development Team
- ✓ Scrum Events
- ✓ How do they Complement Each Other?
- ✓ The Strategy of a Product Owner

Core Components of the Framework

In Scrum, the Scrum Team is comprised of three roles:



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Product Owner

The Product Owner is responsible for maximising the value of the product and the work of the Development Team.

The Product Owner's responsibilities include:

01	Creating and Managing the Product Backlog
02	Defining the Product Vision
03	Communicating with Stakeholders
04	Participating in Scrum Events
05	Making Decisions
06	Ensuring Value Delivery

Scrum Master

The Scrum Master is responsible for ensuring that the Scrum framework is understood and followed by all members of the Scrum Team.

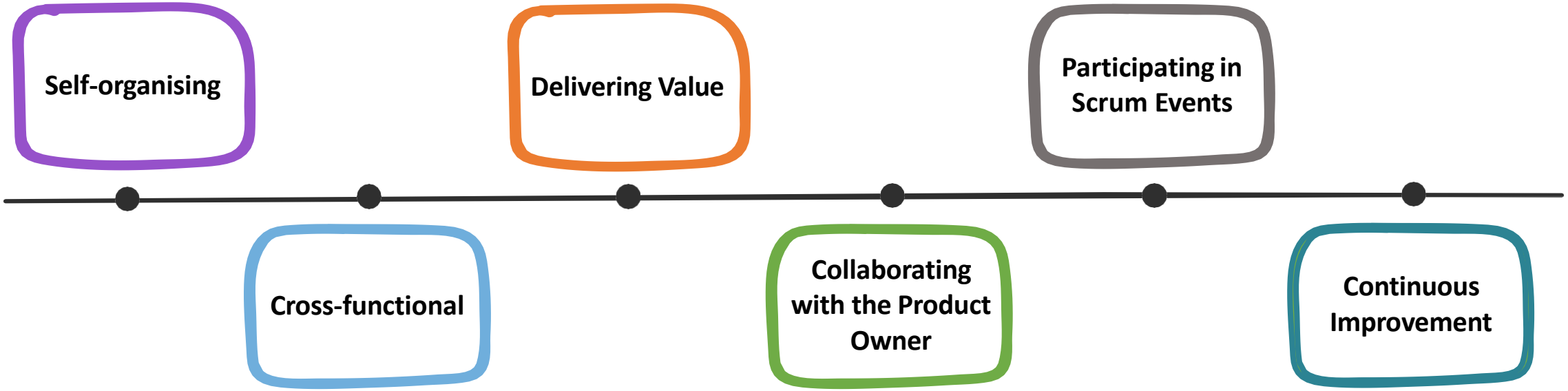
The Scrum Master's responsibilities include:

- Coaching the Scrum Team
- Facilitating Scrum Events
- Removing Obstacles
- Improving Processes

Development Team

The Development Team is responsible for delivering a potentially releasable increment of the product at the end of each Sprint

The Development Team's responsibilities include:



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Scrum Events

In Scrum, there are several events that occur during a Sprint that involve the Scrum Team. These events are time-boxed and are designed to help the team plan, track progress, and make continuous improvements.

The Scrum events are as follows:

- Sprint Planning
- Daily Scrum
- Sprint Review
- Sprint Retrospective

How do they Complement Each Other?

1. Managing and Prioritising the Product Backlog

- ✓ The user stories the development team will work on in subsequent sprints are gathered and prioritised in the product backlog, a crucial document for agile organisations.
- ✓ However, regardless of whether a company uses the agile sprint paradigm, its product owners will devote a significant amount of time to assessing the backlog of development jobs and deciding what the developers should focus on first.
- ✓ This makes it possible to guarantee that the group works according to the product management team's strategic aims and goals.

2. Translating Product Managers' Strategies to Tasks for Development

- ✓ Product owners take the product manager's ideas, turn them into stories or useful bits of value, and collaborate with the engineering team to put them into practise.

How do they Complement Each Other?

3. Learning the Market and Customers' Needs

- ✓ Product owners must comprehend their market and customers' needs in order to be beneficial in converting their company's strategic plan into the appropriate execution processes.
- ✓ This frequently entails collaborating with product managers to find out what issues they hope to address with the product, how consumer needs or desires have shaped their product strategy, and what the team considers a successful product.
- ✓ Product owners may accomplish a number of their tactical tasks daily more successfully by acquiring this high-level understanding of the market, customer persona, and product strategy. These tactical tasks include:
    - Product management epics are being converted into user stories
    - Sprint planning and prioritisation
    - Assessing development's progress at each stage
    - Addressing developer inquiries regarding the justification of user stories or tasks

How do they Complement Each Other?

4. Serving as a Liaison Between Product and Development

- ✓ Product managers establish the overarching objectives and plan for their product's success
- ✓ The engineering or development teams construct the physical (or digital) product
- ✓ But there is a lot of leeway interpretation and misinterpretation—between these two extremes of the product development spectrum
- ✓ Product owners serve as a link between the development and product teams
- ✓ They interpret the product manager's vision and the user-centred goals for each functional area of the product
- ✓ This helps them to communicate to the development team the hows and whys of all the user stories and other activities they prioritise

How do they Complement Each Other?

5. Staying Accessible to Development to Answer Questions

- ✓ The development team may be unsure of a specific assignment while working on stories and other activities throughout a sprint
- ✓ They might not comprehend, for instance, why a user narrative requests that the product functionality be designed in a certain way
- ✓ They might also think they can develop the functionality more quickly and effectively, but they are unsure if doing so might somehow compromise product management's strategic objective
- ✓ The development team should consult the product owner for advice and solutions in these situations
- ✓ The team will need these responses immediately because the company's development sprints are time-boxed—typically lasting two weeks or a month
- ✓ These are the main reasons the product owner needs to be reachable by the development team and be ready to answer their queries immediately

The Strategy of a Product Owner

- ✓ The product owner's primary responsibility is to oversee the product backlog. They are in charge of owning and establishing the product roadmap on customer requirements
- ✓ The product owner must first update the backlog list. Following this step, the list must be correctly categorised according to urgent and significant needs
- ✓ The product owner must clearly understand the objectives and ambitions of the client. It must be clear who needs to be informed and who is relevant
- ✓ The client, the scrum team, the planning committee, and the appropriate management consultants make up this group
- ✓ To comprehend and anticipate client needs, a product owner needs to be sufficiently knowledgeable about the industry and business
- ✓ A product owner must also be conscious of the customer's needs throughout the trip. They will be better equipped to anticipate changes and new needs and comprehend long-term client objectives

The Strategy of a Product Owner

Not Being Afraid to Ask on Request and What is the Real Business Benefit

- ✓ A project's smooth operation is the responsibility of the product owner. The product manager is in charge of preserving and enhancing the product roadmap to maximise the value of the goods
- ✓ Teams can interact and self-organise with flexible approaches like the Scrum process
- ✓ A product owner is a part of the agile team. The primary responsibilities of a product owner are identifying user requirements and creating a product backlog
- ✓ The Product Owner handles any design team questions about critical user needs
- ✓ The Product Owner's objective is to maximise the team's products' potential for profit
- ✓ The product manager asserts that user needs must coincide with client requirements
- ✓ Businesses willing to convert to an agile-based product manufacturing model must prioritise the role of the product owner
- ✓ The product owner must collaborate and preserve excellent working relationships with various partners, such as clients, corporate leaders, development teams, project managers, and other parties

The Strategy of a Product Owner

OKR Frameworks

- ✓ OKRs stand for "Objectives and Key Results." In order to develop tough, ambitious objectives with measurable outcomes, teams and individuals employ this collaborative goal-setting process
- ✓ Using OKRs, individuals may monitor progress toward measurable goals while fostering alignment and engagement
- ✓ OKRs are effective for creating objectives at many different company levels, whether people are talking about office management, software engineering, NGOs, or something else
- ✓ They can be utilised to accomplish personal objectives and even by individuals to do tasks in settings where senior leadership does not employ them

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Module 3:

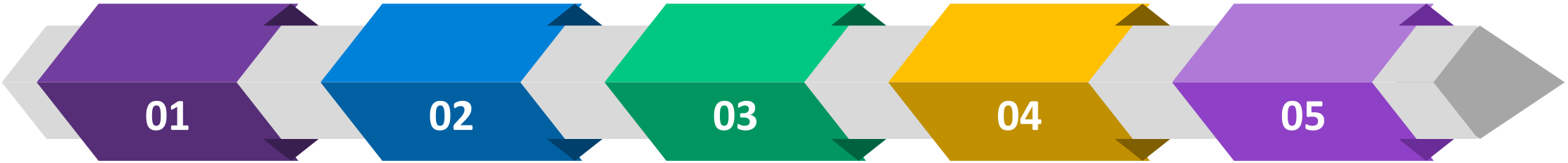
Product Vision and Goals

- ✓ Product Vision
- ✓ Sharing the Vision
- ✓ Product Goals
- ✓ Vision’s Qualities
- ✓ How the Vision can be Shaped?
- ✓ Product Roadmap and Vision

Product Vision

The product vision is a critical component of Scrum as it provides a clear and compelling goal for the entire Scrum Team to work towards. The product vision is a description of what the product will be and the value it will provide to the customers and stakeholders. It serves as the overarching goal that galvanises the Scrum Team and helps to align everyone's efforts towards a common objective.

Having a product vision provides several benefits to the Scrum Team, including:



Clarity | **Focus** | **Alignment** | **Motivation** | **Customer Focus**

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Product Vision

1. Clarity

The product vision provides clarity on what the product will be and the value it will provide to the customers and stakeholders. This clarity helps to align everyone's efforts towards a common objective, ensuring that everyone is working towards the same goal.

2. Focus:

The product vision helps to focus the team's efforts on delivering value to the customers and stakeholders. It provides a clear understanding of what needs to be done and why, which helps the team to stay focused on the most important work.

3. Alignment:

The product vision helps to align the efforts of the entire Scrum Team, ensuring that everyone is working towards the same objective. This alignment helps to avoid conflicting priorities and ensures that everyone is working towards a common goal.

Product Vision

4. Motivation

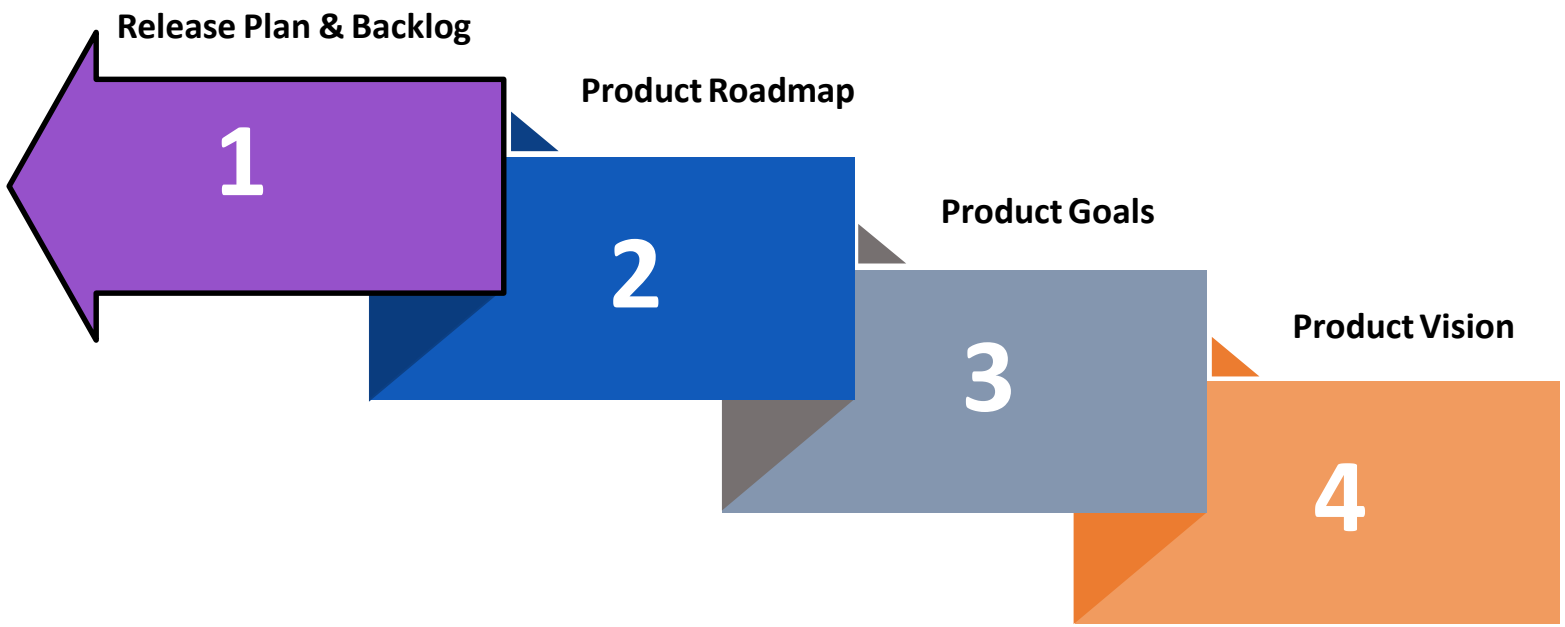
Having a clear and compelling product vision can be motivating for the entire Scrum Team. It provides a sense of purpose and helps to inspire the team to work towards a common objective.

5. Customer Focus

The product vision is customer-focused and helps to ensure that the team is always focused on delivering value to the customers. This focus helps to ensure that the product meets the needs of the customers and provides them with the value they are looking for.

Product Vision

"The vision should communicate the essence of the future product in a concise manner and describe a shared goal that provides direction but is broad enough to facilitate creativity"



Product Vision

FOR <target customer>

- ✓ FOR the bill-paying family member who also uses a home PC
- ✓ FOR post-production film engineers

WHO <statement of the need>

- ✓ WHO is tired of filling out the same old checks month after month
- ✓ WHO are dissatisfied with the limitations of traditional film editors

IS A <product category>

- ✓ Quicken IS A PC home finance program
- ✓ Our workstation IS A digital film editor

THAT <key benefit>

- ✓ THAT automatically creates and tracks all your check-writing
- ✓ THAT lets you modify film images any way you choose

UNLIKE <primary competitor>

- ✓ UNLIKE managing Your Money, a financial analysis package
- ✓ UNLIKE workstations from Sun, HP, or IBM

OUR PRODUCT <further differentiation>

- ✓ OUR system is optimised specifically for home bill-paying
- ✓ WE HAVE assembled all the interfaces needed for post-production film editing

Sharing the Vision

- ✓ The product vision is a picture of the future that describes the customers, what they need, and how the needs will be met. It contains the critical information that influences the development of the product. It should be validates with stakeholders, the Agile Team, and the market.
- ✓ The Vision should be clear, concise, and easy to understand, and broad enough to allow for development. It should also be consistent with the company's vision and strategy.
- ✓ The Product Owner is responsible for creating and communicating the Vision. They should share it often with the team and show a strong commitment to it. However, the Vision should be adapted as each Sprint is completed and should develop with the project.
- ✓ Make sure that when the Vision is communicated, it is based on the target audience, whether it be the Agile Team or different stakeholder groups. This might involve reporting relevant KPIs or representing the product.

Product Goals

When setting goals and objectives for an action plan, be SMART:

Specific
Simple, Significant, Sensible

Measurable
Motivating, Meaningful

Achievable
Attainable, Agreed-upon, Action-oriented

Relevant
Reasonable, Realistic, Resourced, Results-based

Time-bound
Time-based, Time or Cost-limited, Time-Sensitive

Product Goals

1. Specific

- ✓ What do we want to accomplish?
- ✓ Why do we want to accomplish this? What are the reasons/benefits? What is the purpose?
- ✓ Who is involved?
- ✓ What are the requirements/constraints?

2. Measurable

- ✓ How much will it cost?
- ✓ What resources are required?
- ✓ How will we know the goal has been met?

Product Goals

3. Achievable

- ✓ How will this be achieved?
- ✓ How realistic is the goal?

4. Relevant

- ✓ Does this meet our needs?
- ✓ Is it appropriate for the current market?
- ✓ Is this aligned with business strategy and requirements?

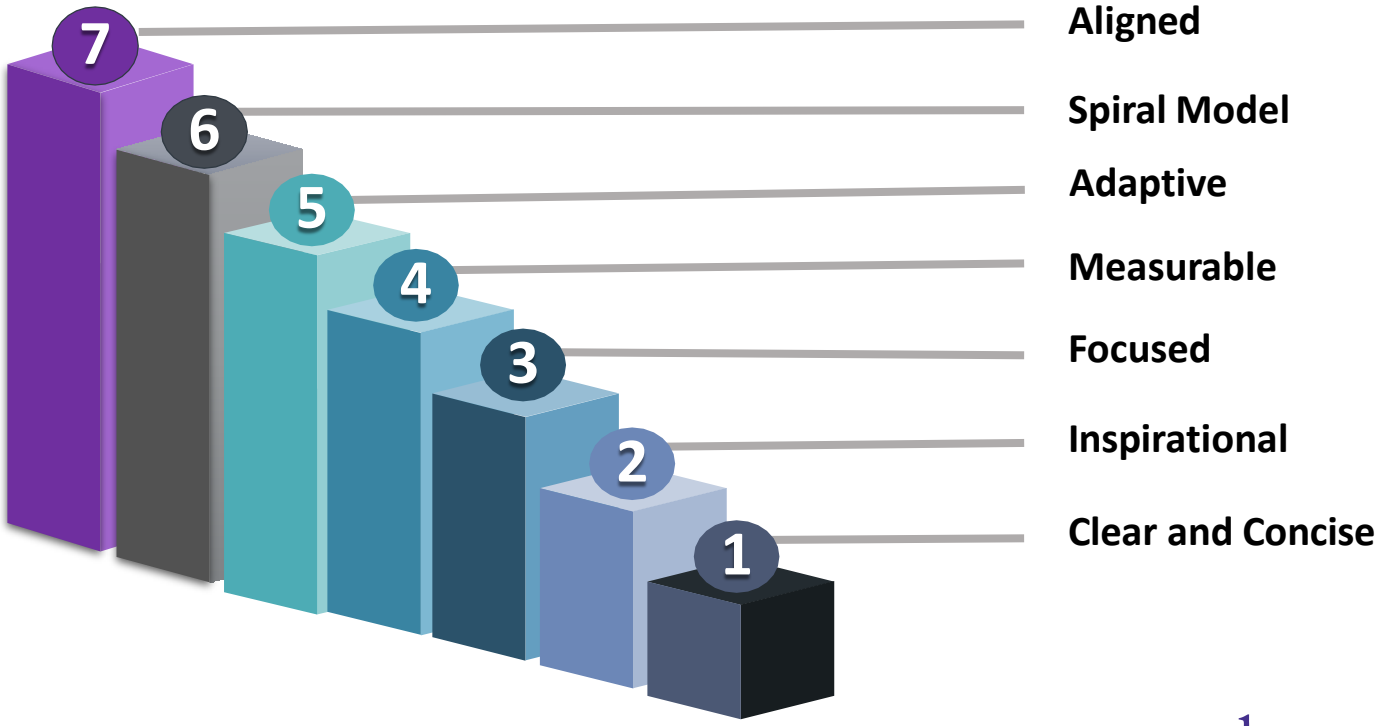
5. Timebound

- ✓ When will this be achieved by?
- ✓ How long will it take?
- ✓ When will we start

Vision's Qualities

- ✓ As the Scrum Product Owner is responsible for setting the vision and direction for the product, there are several qualities that they should possess in order to effectively lead the team towards success.

The vision of the Scrum Product Owner should have the following qualities:



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Vision's Qualities

1 Clear and Concise

The vision should be easy to understand and communicate to the team and stakeholders. It should provide a clear direction for product development and align with the overall business goals.

2 Inspirational

The vision should inspire the team and stakeholders towards a common goal and motivate them to work towards achieving it. It should create a sense of purpose and urgency around product development.

3 Focused

The vision should be focused on addressing the needs and requirements of the end-users and stakeholders. It should prioritise the features and functionalities that will provide the most value to them.

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Vision's Qualities

4 Realistic

The vision should be realistic and achievable within the constraints of the available resources and timeline. The Product Owner should take into account the team's capacity and skills when setting the vision for the product.

5 Measurable

The vision should be measurable in terms of the product's success and impact on the end-users and stakeholders. It should include metrics and key performance indicators (KPIs) that can be used to evaluate the progress towards achieving the vision.

6 Adaptive

The vision should be adaptable to changing market and business conditions. The Product Owner should be open to feedback and be willing to adjust the vision as needed to ensure that it continues to align with the overall business goals and priorities.

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Vision's Qualities

7

Aligned

The vision should be aligned with the Scrum framework and Agile principles. It should emphasise collaboration, feedback, and continuous improvement, and be responsive to the changing needs of the end-users and stakeholders.

How the Vision can be Shaped

Shaping the vision for a Scrum Product Owner involves a collaborative effort between the Product Owner, stakeholders, and the development team.

The following are some steps that can be followed to shape the vision:

01 Identify the Target Audience

02 Gather Feedback

03 Define the Problem Statement

04 Set Goals and Objectives

05 Create a Vision Statement

06 Refine the Vision

How the Vision can be Shaped

1. Identify the Target Audience

The Product Owner should identify the target audience for the product and understand their needs and pain points.

2. Gather Feedback

The Product Owner should gather feedback from the end-users, stakeholders, and the development team to identify areas for improvement and prioritise features.

3. Define the Problem Statement

The Product Owner should define the problem statement that the product is intended to solve. This statement should be clear, concise, and focused on the needs of the target audience.

4. Set Goals and Objectives

The Product Owner should set goals and objectives for the product based on the problem statement and feedback gathered. These goals and objectives should be measurable and aligned with the overall business strategy.

How the Vision can be Shaped

5. Create a Vision Statement

Based on the problem statement, feedback, and goals, the Product Owner should create a vision statement that communicates the purpose and direction of the product in a clear and concise manner.

6. Refine the Vision

The Product Owner should refine the vision based on feedback from stakeholders and the development team. The vision statement should be revisited and updated regularly to ensure that it remains relevant and aligned with the changing needs of the business and end-users.

Relationship Between Product Roadmap and Vision

Relationship	Potential	Product Roadmap
Communication	Can be used to communicate progress towards achieving the product vision to stakeholders and the development team	Shows the steps and milestones that need to be completed to achieve the vision
Wishlist Page	Guides the prioritisation of features and functionality	Changes to the roadmap should not deviate from the overall product direction guided by the vision
Clarity	Provides a clear long-term direction for the product	Should provide clarity on how the product will evolve over time to achieve the vision, outlining the key features and functionality that will be added in each release

Relationship Between Product Roadmap and Vision

Relationship	Potential	Product Roadmap
Alignment	Provides the long-term direction and purpose for the product	Should be aligned with the product vision to ensure that each step of the roadmap moves the product towards achieving the overall vision
Prioritisation	Guides the prioritisation of features and functionality	Should prioritise the items on the roadmap based on their importance in achieving the vision

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Module 4: Estimating

- ✓ Understand the Different Evaluation Levels in the Scrum Scope
- ✓ Understanding the Precision of an Estimate is more Important than the Precision of the Estimate
- ✓ Estimates of Size and Duration
- ✓ Difference Between Estimating and Committing

Understand the Different Evaluation Levels in the Scrum Scope

✓ In Scrum, there are several levels of evaluation that occur within the framework

These levels include:

- Product Vision 01
- Product Backlog 02
- Sprint Goals 03
- Sprint Backlog 04
- Daily Scrum 05
- Sprint Review 06
- Sprint Retrospective 07

Understand the Different Evaluation Levels in the Scrum Scope

01 Product Vision

- ✓ The Product Owner is responsible for defining the product vision, which is the overarching goal of the product
- ✓ This vision provides guidance to the team on what the product should achieve and what value it should provide to customers

02 Product Backlog

- ✓ The Product Owner is also responsible for maintaining and prioritising the product backlog, which is a list of features, functions, and requirements that must be completed in order to achieve the product vision
- ✓ The product backlog is constantly evolving as new information becomes available and priorities change

Understand the Different Evaluation Levels in the Scrum Scope

03 Sprint Goals

- ✓ At the beginning of each sprint, the team works with the Product Owner to define a sprint goal, which is a specific objective that the team will work towards during the sprint
- ✓ This goal should align with the product vision and the items in the product backlog

04 Sprint Backlog

- ✓ Once the sprint goal has been defined, the team creates a sprint backlog, which is a list of tasks and activities that must be completed in order to achieve the sprint goal
- ✓ The sprint backlog is based on the items in the product backlog and is constantly updated throughout the sprint as progress is made

Understand the Different Evaluation Levels in the Scrum Scope

05 Daily Scrum

- ✓ During the sprint, the team holds a daily scrum, which is a short meeting where team members discuss progress, identify any roadblocks, and plan the work for the next 24 hours
- ✓ The Product Owner is also involved in the daily scrum to ensure that progress is being made towards the sprint goal

06 Sprint Review

- ✓ At the end of the sprint, the team holds a sprint review, where they demonstrate the work that has been completed to stakeholders and receive feedback
- ✓ The Product Owner provides feedback on the work completed and helps to identify any areas where the team needs to make adjustmentS

Understand the Different Evaluation Levels in the Scrum Scope

07 Sprint Retrospective

- ✓ After the sprint review, the team holds a sprint retrospective, where they reflect on the sprint and identify areas for improvement
- ✓ The Product Owner provides feedback on the product backlog and helps to prioritise items for future sprints

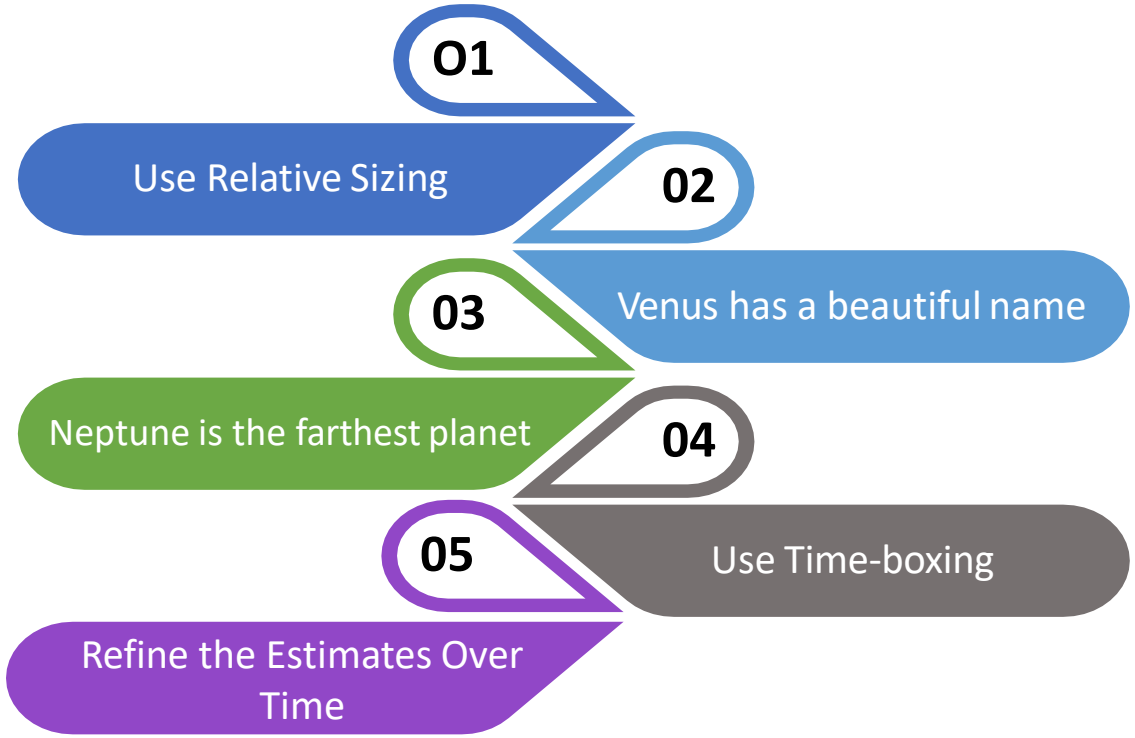
Understanding the Precision of an Estimate is more Important than the Precision of the Estimate

- ✓ In Scrum, the Product Owner is responsible for maximising the value of the product and ensuring that the team is working on the most important items.
- ✓ One of the ways the Product Owner does this is by creating and maintaining a Product Backlog, which is a prioritised list of features and requirements for the product.
- ✓ When estimating the size of the work items in the Product Backlog, it's important to remember that the precision of the estimate is less important than the precision of the estimate's relative size.
- ✓ This is because the purpose of estimating the work items is not to create a perfect plan, but rather to provide a common understanding of the work involved so that the Product Owner can prioritise the backlog and the Development Team can plan their work during a Sprint.
- ✓ Therefore, it is important for the Product Owner to focus on creating estimates that are consistently sized relative to one another, rather than trying to create estimates that are overly precise or accurate

Estimates of Size and Duration

- ✓ As a Scrum Product Owner, one of your responsibilities is to estimate the size and duration of the work items in the Product Backlog. The size and duration estimates can help you prioritise the items in the Product Backlog and plan the work for the upcoming Sprint.

Some key points to keep in mind when estimating size and duration in Scrum:



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Estimates of Size and Duration

1. Use Relative Sizing

- ✓ In Scrum, it is common to use relative sizing instead of absolute sizing when estimating the size of work items. Relative sizing involves comparing the size of one work item to another, rather than assigning an actual numerical value to it.
- ✓ This helps to create a consistent understanding of the relative size of each item in the Product Backlog, which can be useful for prioritisation.

2. Involve the Development Team

- ✓ The Development Team is responsible for executing the work and has a good understanding of the technical complexities involved in each item.
- ✓ Therefore, it is important to involve the Development Team in the estimation process to get a more accurate estimate of the size and duration of the work items.

Estimates of Size and Duration

3. Consider Different Factors

- ✓ When estimating the size and duration of work items, it is important to consider various factors such as complexity, dependencies, and risk. **For example**, a work item that has many dependencies may take longer to complete than a similar work item with fewer dependencies.

4. Use Time-boxing

- ✓ In Scrum, time-boxing is a technique used to limit the amount of time spent on an activity. When estimating the size and duration of work items, it is important to use time-boxing to avoid spending too much time on the estimation process. **For example**, you can use a time box of 1-2 hours for estimating the work items in the Product Backlog.

5. Refine the Estimates Over Time

- ✓ Estimates are not set in stone and can change as more information becomes available
- ✓ Therefore, it is important to refine the estimates over time as more information becomes available and to use the estimates as a tool for prioritisation rather than a strict plan.

Difference Between Estimating and Committing

Aspect	Estimating	Committing
Definition	A forecast of the amount of work that can be completed in a given time period	A promise to complete a specific set of work within a given time period
Responsibility	Primarily the responsibility of the Scrum Product Owner, with input from the Development Team	The Development Team is responsible for committing to the work they can complete in the upcoming Sprint
Flexibility	Estimates are not set in stone and can be adjusted based on new information or changes in circumstances	Once committed, the work should be completed within the Sprint timeframe
Level of detail	Estimates can be relatively high level, using techniques such as relative sizing or story points	Commitments should be specific and concrete, with a clear definition of done

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Difference Between Estimating and Committing

Aspect	Estimating	Committing
Purpose	Estimates are used to prioritise work and plan upcoming Sprints	Commitments are used to hold the Development Team accountable for delivering the work they committed to
Accountability	The Scrum Product Owner is accountable for the accuracy of the estimates	The Development Team is accountable for delivering on their commitments
Collaborative	Estimating is a collaborative process that involves input from both the Scrum Product Owner and the Development Team	Committing is a collaborative process that involves agreement between the Development Team and the Scrum Product Owner

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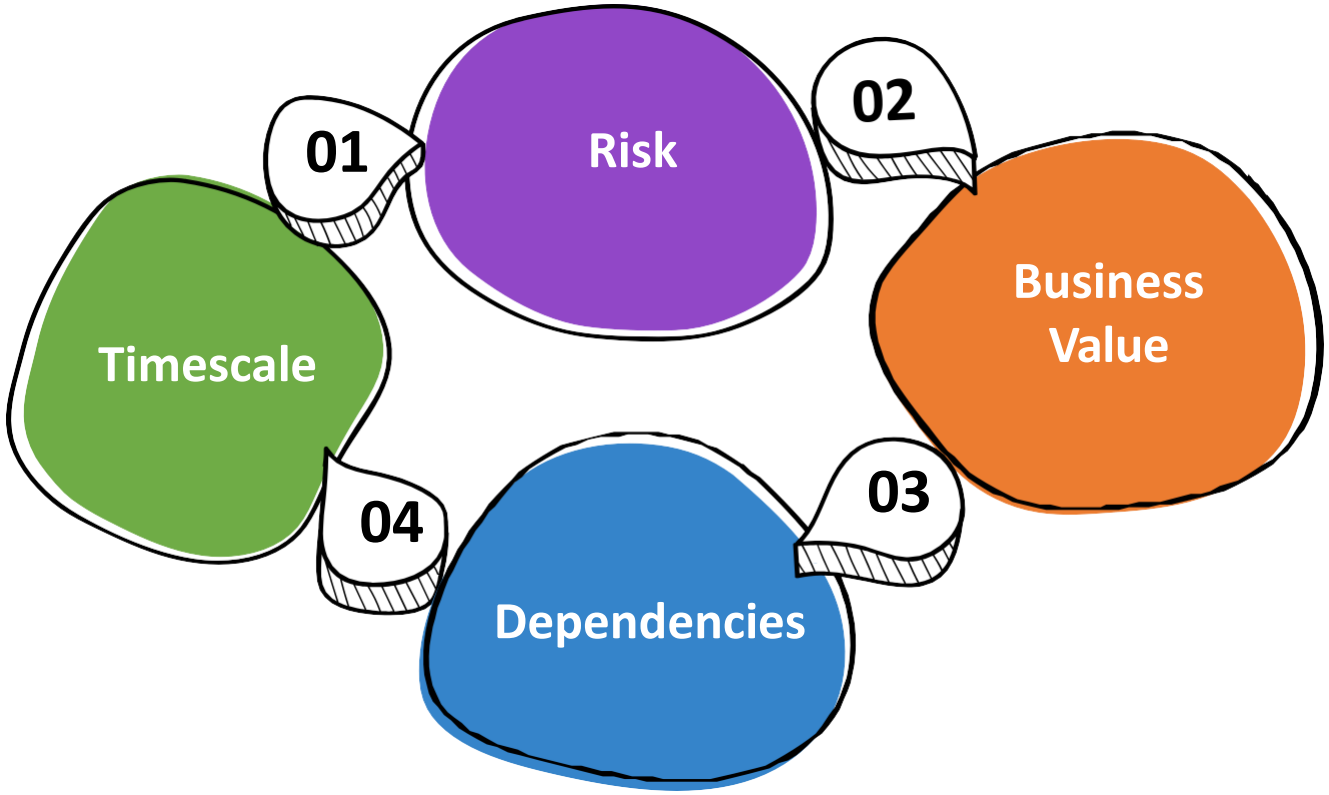
Module 5: Product Backlog

- ✓ The Product Backlog
- ✓ Product Backlog – DEEP
- ✓ Product Backlog Grooming

The Product Backlog

✓ The Product backlog is an ordered list of “requirements” maintained for a product

It contains items ordered by the Product Owner based on:



The Product Backlog

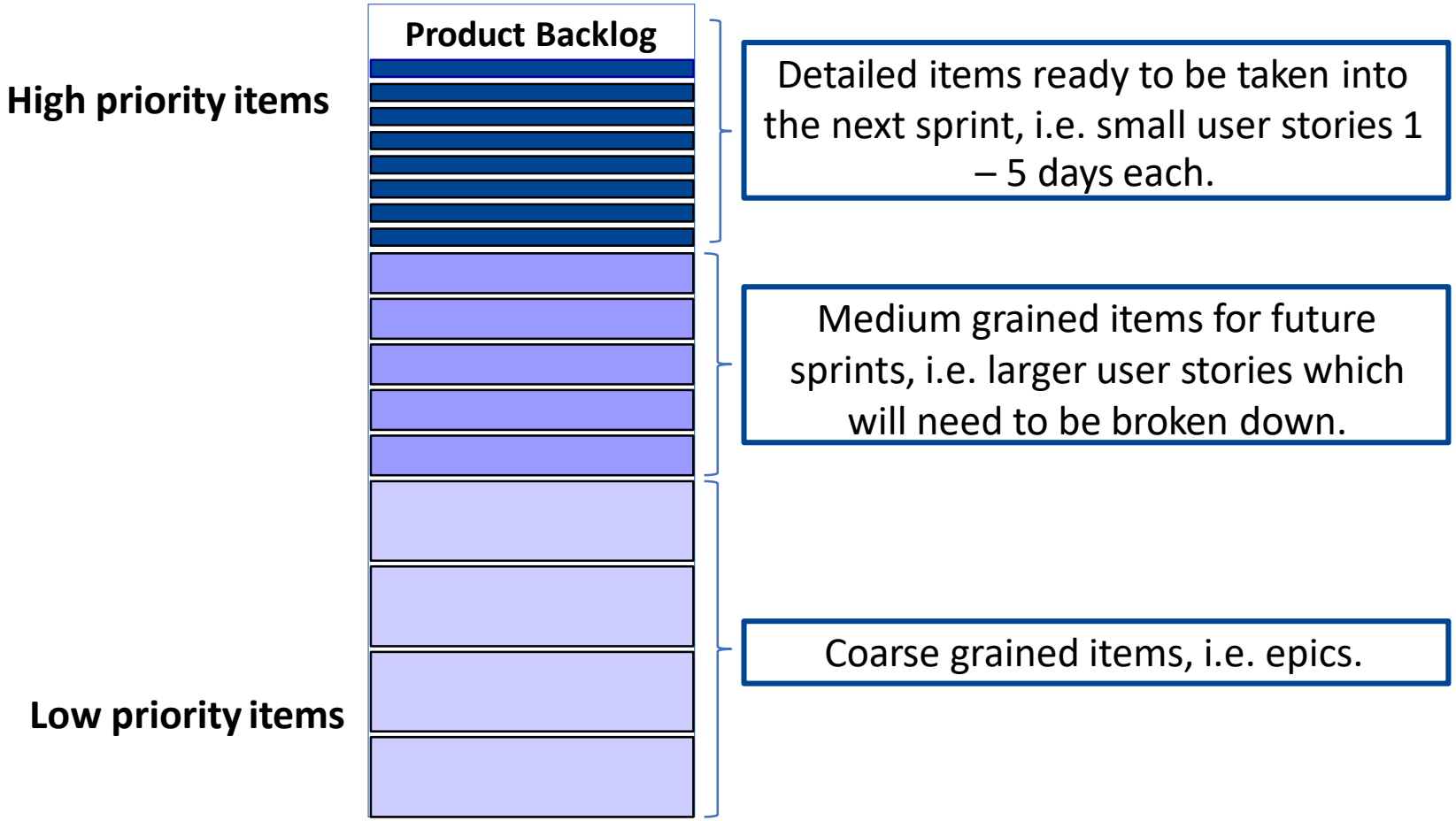
The requirements

- ✓ A list of all desired work on the project
- ✓ Ideally expressed such that each item has value to the users or customers of the product
- ✓ Prioritised by the product owner
- ✓ Reprioritised at the start of each sprint
- ✓ Features added to the backlog are commonly written in story format
- ✓ The product backlog is “What” will be built, sorted in the relative order it should be built
- ✓ While open and editable by anyone, the Product Owner is ultimately responsible for ordering the stories on the backlog for the Development Team

The Product Backlog

- ✓ It will also contain rough estimates of both business value and development effort, often stated in story points using a rounded Fibonacci sequence.
- ✓ The estimates help the Product Owner to gauge the timeline and may influence the ordering of backlog items.
    - E.g. If two support features have the same business value, the one with the smallest development effort will most likely have higher priority since the return on investments is higher.
- ✓ Items/requirements are reprioritised at the start of each sprint.

The Product Backlog



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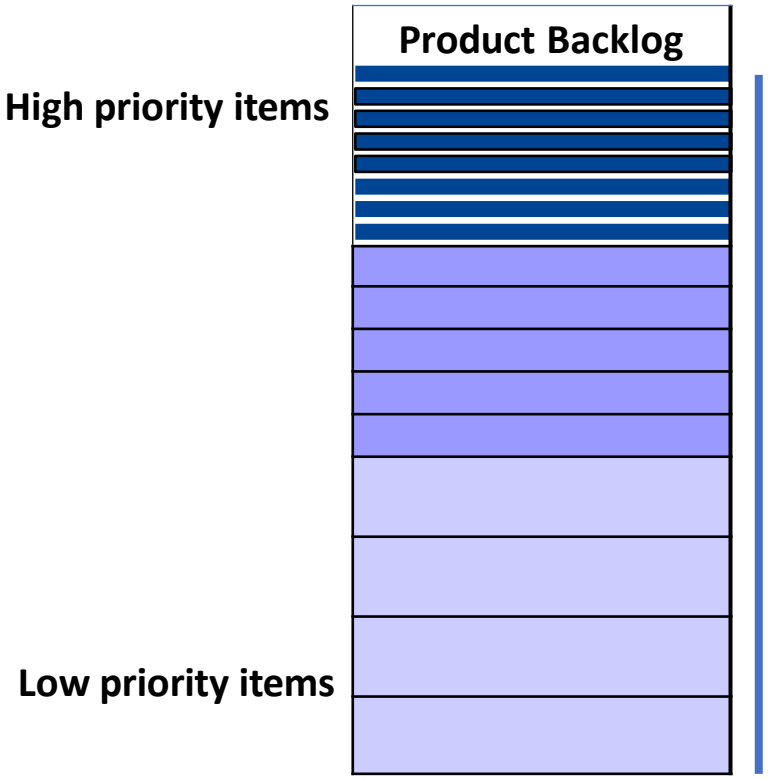
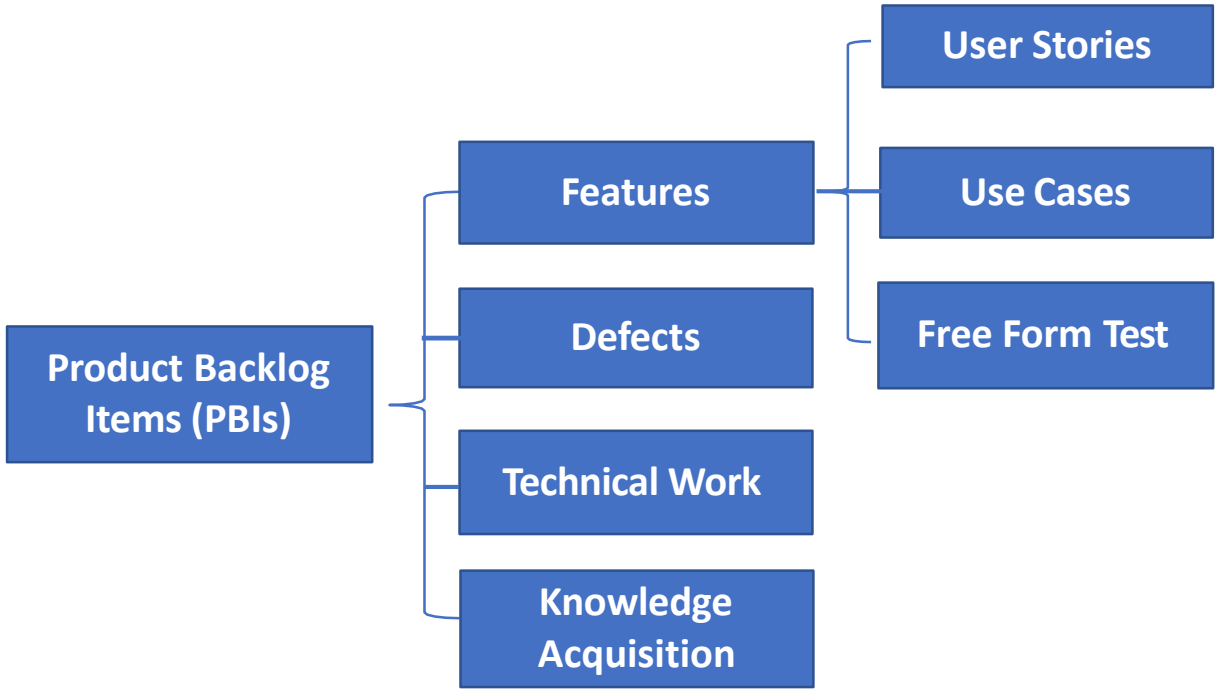
The Product Backlog





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Product Backlog – DEEP

1. Detailed Appropriately

- ✓ User stories on the Product Backlog should be understood sufficiently for completion during an upcoming sprint. Stories that will not be developed until a later date should be described with less detail

2. Estimated

- ✓ Since items further down the backlog are not fully understood yet, estimates are less precise compared to items at the top

3. Emergent

- ✓ The backlog changes over time as more is learned. User stories will be added, removed, and/or reprioritised

4. Prioritised

- ✓ The most valuable items should be at the top with the least at the bottom. Working in priority order maximises the value of that which is being developed

Product Backlog – DEEP

5. Large items

- ✓ Too large to be contained in a release and referred to as epics

6. Medium items

- ✓ Larger than a single sprint, but smaller than a release. These will normally take weeks to complete and are often referred to as features

7. Small items

- ✓ These are items that appropriately sized for a Sprint, capable of completion within days rather than weeks. These can be broken down into tasks for delivery

Product Backlog Grooming

- ✓ Product backlog grooming, also known as product backlog refinement, is a continuous process in Scrum where the Scrum Product Owner and the Scrum Team work together to review and improve the product backlog.

- ✓ The purpose of backlog grooming is to ensure that the product backlog items are clearly defined, prioritised, and ready to be worked on by the Scrum Team in the upcoming Sprint.

Product Backlog Grooming

During the product backlog grooming sessions, the Scrum Product Owner and the Scrum Team collaborate to:

01 Add New Items to the Product Backlog

02 Clarify Existing Items

03 Prioritise the Items

04 Estimate the Items

05 Remove Obsolete Items

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Product Backlog Grooming

Add New Items to the Product Backlog	✓ The Scrum Product Owner may add new items to the backlog based on changes in the product vision or market conditions.
Clarify Existing Items	✓ The Scrum Product Owner and the Scrum Team work together to ensure that the items in the product backlog are clear, concise, and unambiguous. ✓ This includes defining the acceptance criteria, creating user stories, and breaking down large items into smaller, more manageable ones.
Remove Obsolete Item	✓ The Scrum Product Owner and the Scrum Team work together to prioritise the product backlog items based on the value they provide to the end-users. ✓ This ensures that the most valuable items are at the top of the backlog.

Product Backlog Grooming

Estimate the Items	✓ The Scrum Team may provide estimates for the product backlog items using techniques such as relative sizing or story points. ✓ This helps the Scrum Product Owner to better plan and prioritise the work for upcoming Sprints.
Remove Obsolete Items	✓ The Scrum Product Owner may remove items from the product backlog that are no longer relevant or necessary.

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Module 6: Prioritisation

- ✓ Value and Benefits of Precedence the Product Backlog
- ✓ Prioritisation Decisions
- ✓ Understand Correct Prioritisation of a Product Backlog
- ✓ What is MoSCoW?
- ✓ Kano Model
- ✓ Kano Model Process

Value and Benefits of Precedence the Product Backlog

✓ There are several values and benefits of precedence the product backlog in Scrum Product Owner. Some of these include:

01 Clarity and Alignment

02 Prioritisation

03 Flexibility

04 Better Sprint Planning

05 Increased Transparency

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Value and Benefits of Precedence the Product Backlog

1. Maximizing Product Value

- ✓ By carefully prioritizing the Product Backlog, the Product Owner ensures that the Development Team works on the most valuable items first. This approach aligns with the principle of delivering the highest value to the customers as early as possible, thereby maximizing the return on investment (ROI) for the stakeholders.

2. Prioritisation

- ✓ Prioritisation is a critical activity that directly influences the effectiveness of the development team. It is the process of sequencing the work to be done to maximize value and align with business objectives. It is not a one-time activity but a continuous process, as the product backlog is a living document that evolves as new information becomes available.

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Value and Benefits of Precedence the Product Backlog

3. Flexibility

- ✓ Precedence the product backlog allows the Scrum Team to be more flexible and responsive to changes in the market or product vision.
- ✓ By prioritising the items in the backlog, the team can quickly shift their focus to the most important work as needed.

4. Better Sprint Planning

- ✓ Precedence the product backlog helps to improve the accuracy of Sprint planning.
- ✓ By having a well-prioritised backlog, the Scrum Team can better estimate the amount of work they can complete in a Sprint and ensure that they are delivering value to the end-users.

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Value and Benefits of Precedence the Product Backlog

5. Increased Transparency

- ✓ Precedence the product backlog makes the product development process more transparent.
- ✓ By regularly reviewing and updating the product backlog, the Scrum Team and stakeholders can see the progress being made and the work that still needs to be done.

Prioritisation Decisions

- ✓ In Scrum, the Product Owner is responsible for prioritising the Product Backlog and making decisions about what should be included in each Sprint.
- ✓ The Product Owner should have the primary role in deciding what features and functionality should be built, and in what order they should be delivered.
- ✓ However, it is important to note that the Product Owner should not be working in isolation.
- ✓ They should be collaborating closely with the development team and other stakeholders to make informed decisions that are in the best interest of the product and its users.
- ✓ The development team can provide valuable insights into the technical feasibility of certain features, as well as estimates of how long they will take to develop.

Prioritisation Decisions

- ✓ Other stakeholders, such as marketing, sales, and customer support teams, may also have input into the prioritisation process.
- ✓ They can provide valuable information about customer needs and preferences, market trends, and competitive pressures.
- ✓ Ultimately, the Product Owner has the final say in prioritisation decisions.
- ✓ However, they should take into account the input and feedback of the development team and other stakeholders to ensure that the product backlog reflects the needs of all parties involved.
- ✓ Effective communication and collaboration are essential to making informed decisions and delivering a successful product.

Understand Correct Prioritisation of a Product Backlog

- ✓ Prioritising the product backlog is a critical responsibility of the Scrum Product Owner. The correct prioritisation ensures that the most valuable and high-priority items are worked on first, which can lead to better customer satisfaction and faster delivery of the product.

The following are some tips for correct prioritisation of the product backlog in Scrum:

1. Understand the Product Vision
2. Gather Feedback from Stakeholders
3. Evaluate Impact and Effort
4. The temperament, Nature and Characters of the Parties
5. Be Flexible

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Understand Correct Prioritisation of a Product Backlog

1. Understand the Product Vision

✓ To prioritize effectively, the Product Owner must have a deep understanding of the product vision. This overarching vision serves as a guiding star for all decisions made about the product. It's critical to align the backlog with this vision to ensure that every feature, story, or task contributes toward the end goal. The product vision should encapsulate the unique value proposition of the product and the main problems it aims to solve for users.

2. Gather Feedback from Stakeholders

✓ Feedback from stakeholders, including customers, business managers, and the development team, is invaluable. Their insights can help identify which features are most needed, reveal what isn't working, and inform the prioritization process. This collaborative approach ensures that the product development is driven by real user needs and business objectives, rather than assumptions.

Understand Correct Prioritisation of a Product Backlog

3. Evaluate Impact and Effort

✓ Assess each backlog item's potential impact on the users and business against the effort required to deliver it. This cost-benefit analysis is a common prioritization method, often visualized with a matrix that helps to decide which items should be tackled first. High-impact, low-effort items are typically prioritized over those with lower impact and higher effort.

4. The Temperament, Nature, and Characters of the Parties

✓ Understanding the personalities and work styles of the development team and stakeholders can also influence prioritization. For instance, if certain team members have specialized skills suited for particular tasks, it may make sense to prioritize those tasks when those team members are available. Similarly, stakeholder preferences, political considerations, and organizational culture can all impact the order in which items are addressed.

Understand Correct Prioritisation of a Product Backlog

5. Be Flexible

✓ Priorities can shift rapidly due to changes in the market, feedback from users, or internal decisions. The Product Owner must remain flexible, regularly revising and adjusting the backlog. This agility ensures that the product stays relevant and that the team is always working on what delivers the highest value at any given time.

What is MoSCoW?

- ✓ MoSCoW is a method for prioritisation developed by Dai Clegg and first propagated by the agile project delivery methodology Dynamic Systems Development Method (DSDM).
- ✓ MoSCoW is a prioritisation technique that is commonly used in Scrum Product Owner to help prioritise items in the product backlog.
- ✓ MoSCoW has applications and/or is used in Scrum, DSDM and Rapid Application Development (RAD).
- ✓ In a DSDM project where time has been fixed, it is vital to understand the relative importance of the work to be done in order to make progress and keep to deadlines.
- ✓ Prioritisation can be applied to requirements/user stories, tasks, products, use cases, acceptance criteria and tests, although it is most commonly applied to requirements/ User Stories.

What is MoSCoW?

The technique involves categorising items into four categories:

Must Have

- ✓ These are items that are critical to the product's success and must be completed in order to deliver a working product.
- ✓ These items are non-negotiable and must be included in the product backlog.

Should Have

- ✓ These are items that are important to the product's success but are not critical.
- ✓ These items should be included in the product backlog but can be moved to a later sprint if necessary.

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What is MoSCoW?

The technique involves categorising items into four categories:

Could Have

- ✓ These are items that are nice to have but are not essential.
- ✓ These items should be included in the product backlog but can be deprioritised or deferred to a later sprint.

Won't Have

- ✓ These are items that are not necessary for the product's success and will not be included in the product backlog.
- ✓ These items may be considered for future releases or may be discarded altogether.

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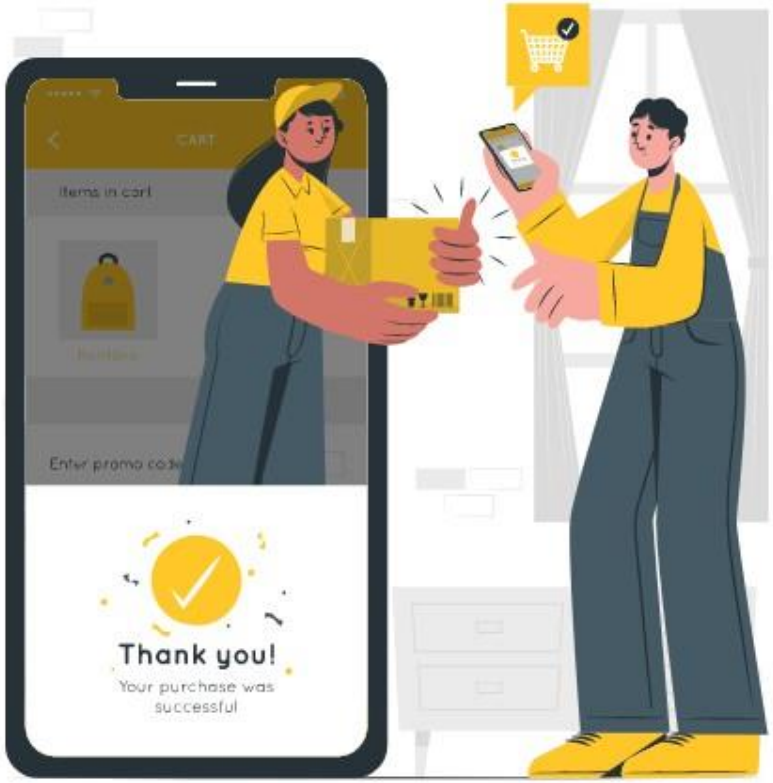
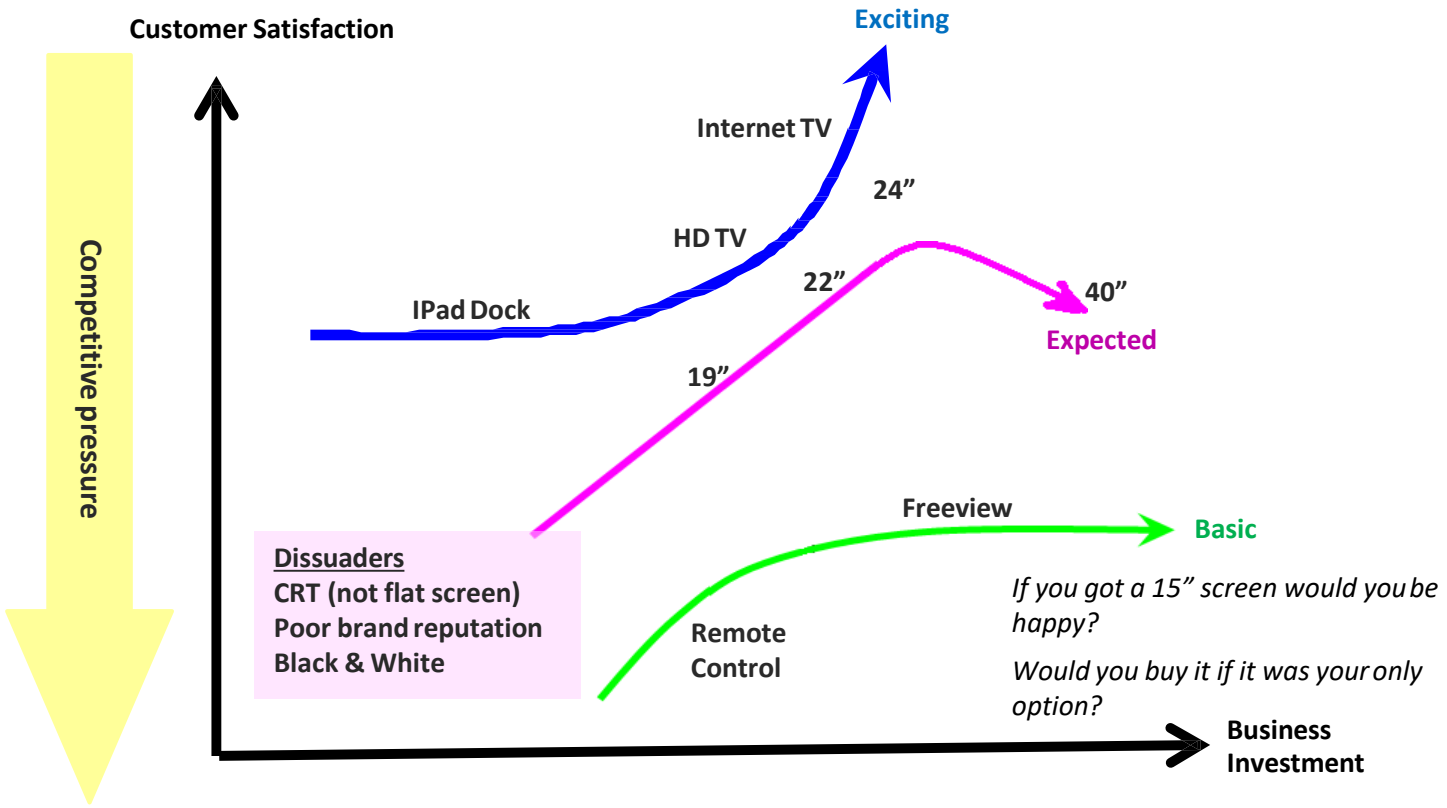
What is MoSCoW?

- ✓ Using the MoSCoW technique, the Product Owner can prioritise items in the product backlog based on their level of importance and urgency.
- ✓ This helps ensure that the most important and critical items are completed first, while also allowing the team to focus on delivering items that are important but not critical.
- ✓ MoSCoW technique should be used as a guideline and not a strict rule.
- ✓ The Product Owner should be open to adjusting priorities based on changing requirements or feedback from stakeholders. The ultimate goal is to deliver a product that meets the needs of the customer and the business.



Kano Model

The Kano Model is a prioritisation technique that is commonly used in Scrum Product Owner to help prioritise items in the product backlog. The technique involves categorising items into three categories: Basic, Performance, and Delight.



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Kano Model

Here is a breakdown of each category:

- ✓ **Basic**

  These are items that are expected by the customer and are considered basic requirements. If these requirements are not met, the customer will be dissatisfied. Examples of basic requirements include reliable performance, easy-to-use interface, and error-free functionality.

- ✓ **Performance**

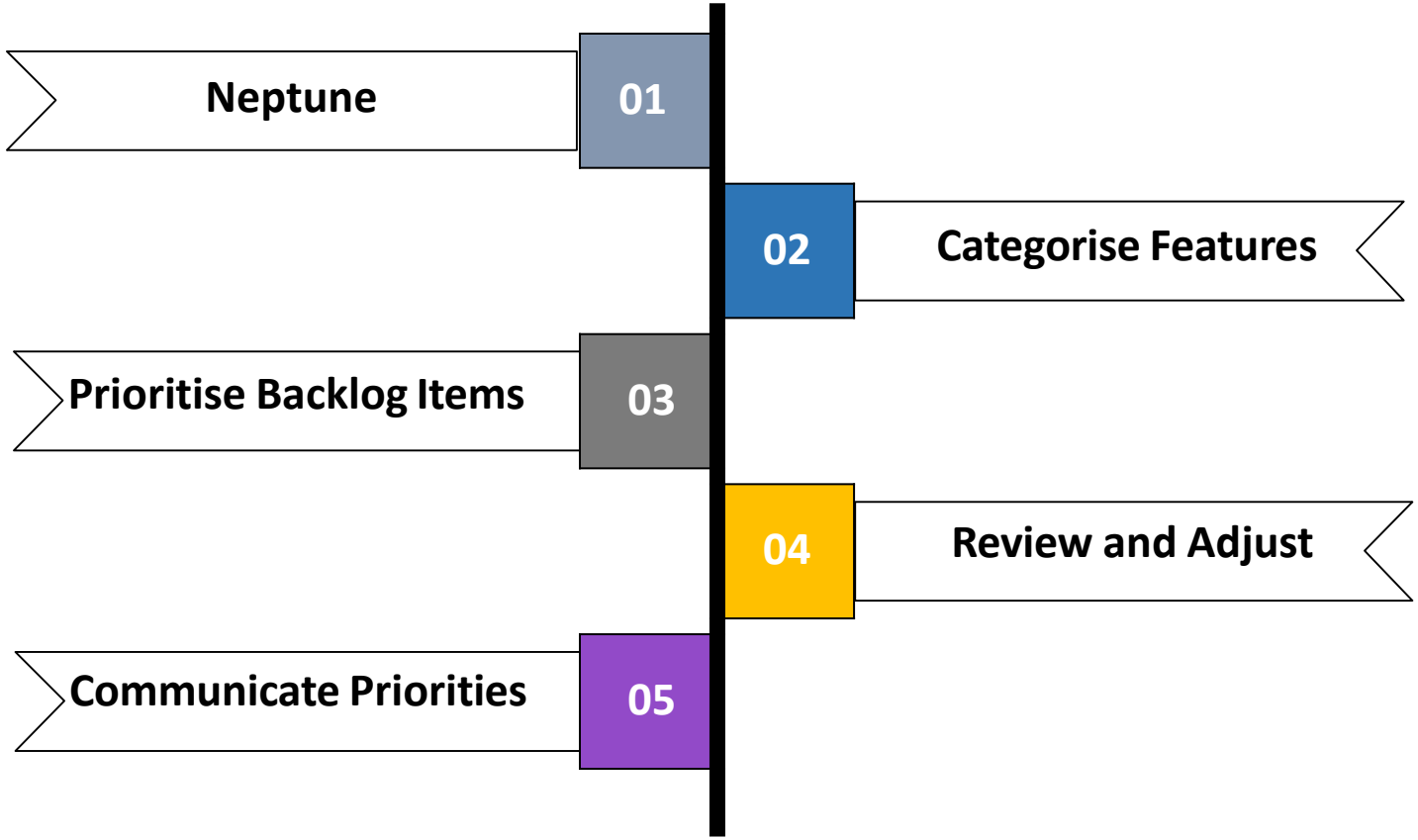
  These are items that add value to the customer and increase satisfaction. Meeting these requirements will result in a higher level of customer satisfaction. Examples of performance requirements include faster performance, more features, and more flexibility.

- ✓ **Delight**

  These are items that exceed the customer's expectations and create a "wow" factor. Meeting these requirements will result in a high level of customer satisfaction and loyalty. Examples of delight requirements include unexpected features, personalised experience, and exceptional customer service.

Kano Model Process

The following is an example of how the Kano Model process can be applied in Scrum Product Owner:



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Kano Model Process

1. **Identify Customer Needs**

   The first step in applying the Kano Model in Scrum is to identify the customer needs and expectations. This can be done through market research, customer surveys, feedback from stakeholders, and other methods.

2. **Categorise Features**

   Once the customer needs have been identified, the next step is to categorise the features in the product backlog based on the Kano Model categories: Basic, Performance, and Delight.

3. **Prioritise Backlog Items**

   Once the features have been categorised, the Product Owner can prioritise them based on their impact on customer satisfaction and overall value to the product. Basic features should be prioritised first, followed by performance features, and finally delight features.

Kano Model Process

4. Review and Adjust

It is important to regularly review and adjust the prioritisation based on customer feedback, changing requirements, and new information. This helps ensure that the product meets the needs and expectations of the customer.

5. Communicate Priorities

Finally, the Product Owner should communicate the priorities to the Scrum team and stakeholders to ensure that everyone is aligned and working towards the same goals.

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Module 7: Sprints

- ✓ Role Product Owner in the Scrum Meetings
- ✓ Sprint Process
- ✓ Sprint Planning
- ✓ The Sprint Backlog
- ✓ Managing the Sprint Backlog
- ✓ The Development Work
- ✓ Sprint Review

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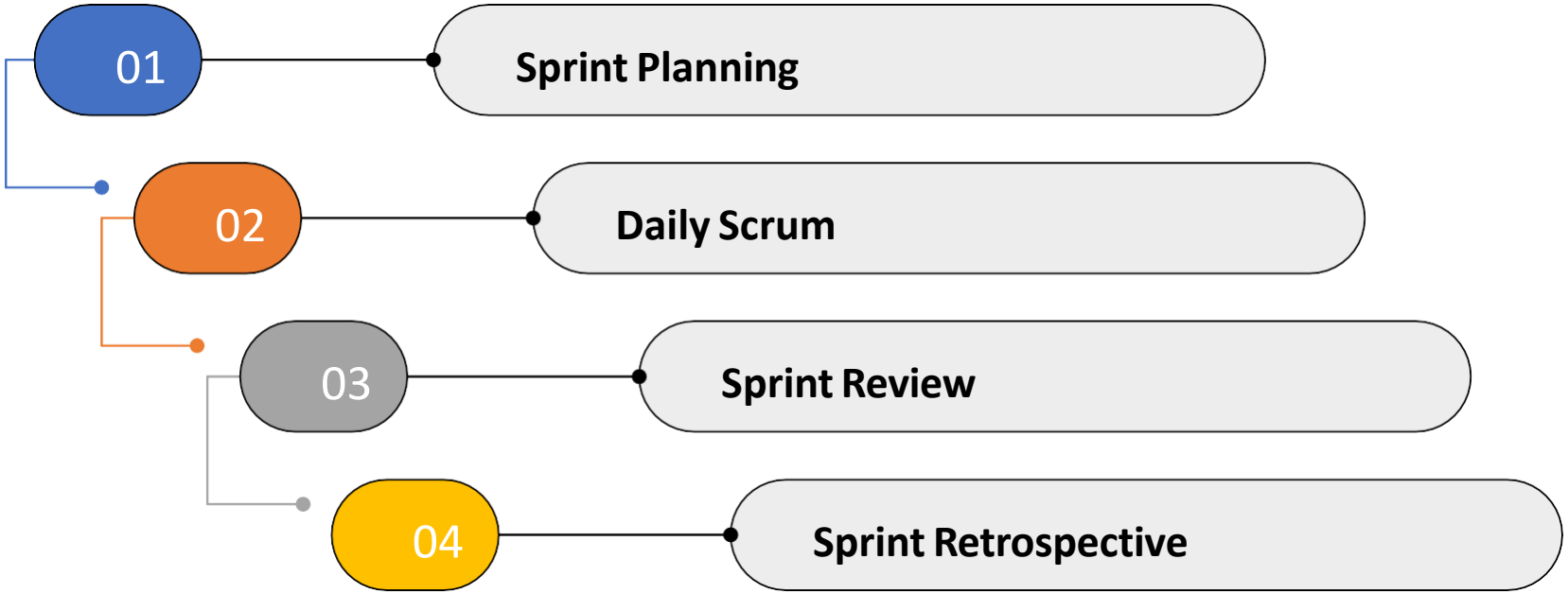
Module 7: Sprints

- ✓ Sprint Retrospective
- ✓ Increment
- ✓ How the Development Team and Product Owner Collaborate During the Sprint
- ✓ What is Team Commitment?
- ✓ Sustainable Pace
- ✓ Sprints are Timeboxed and Protected

Role Product Owner in the Scrum Meetings

As the Product Owner in a Scrum team, you play a crucial role in the Scrum meetings. These meetings are designed to ensure that the team is aligned and working towards the same goal, and as the Product Owner, you have a unique perspective and responsibility in these meetings.

Here is a brief overview of your role in each of the Scrum meetings:



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Role Product Owner in the Scrum Meetings

1. Sprint Planning

In this meeting, you work with the team to identify the work that will be done during the upcoming sprint. You will provide guidance on the priority of the tasks to ensure the most valuable items are completed first.

2. Daily Scrum

This is a brief meeting that occurs every day, where the team provides updates on their progress and identifies any obstacles they are facing. As the Product Owner, you attend these meetings to listen and provide input on any issues that may impact the product.

Role Product Owner in the Scrum Meetings

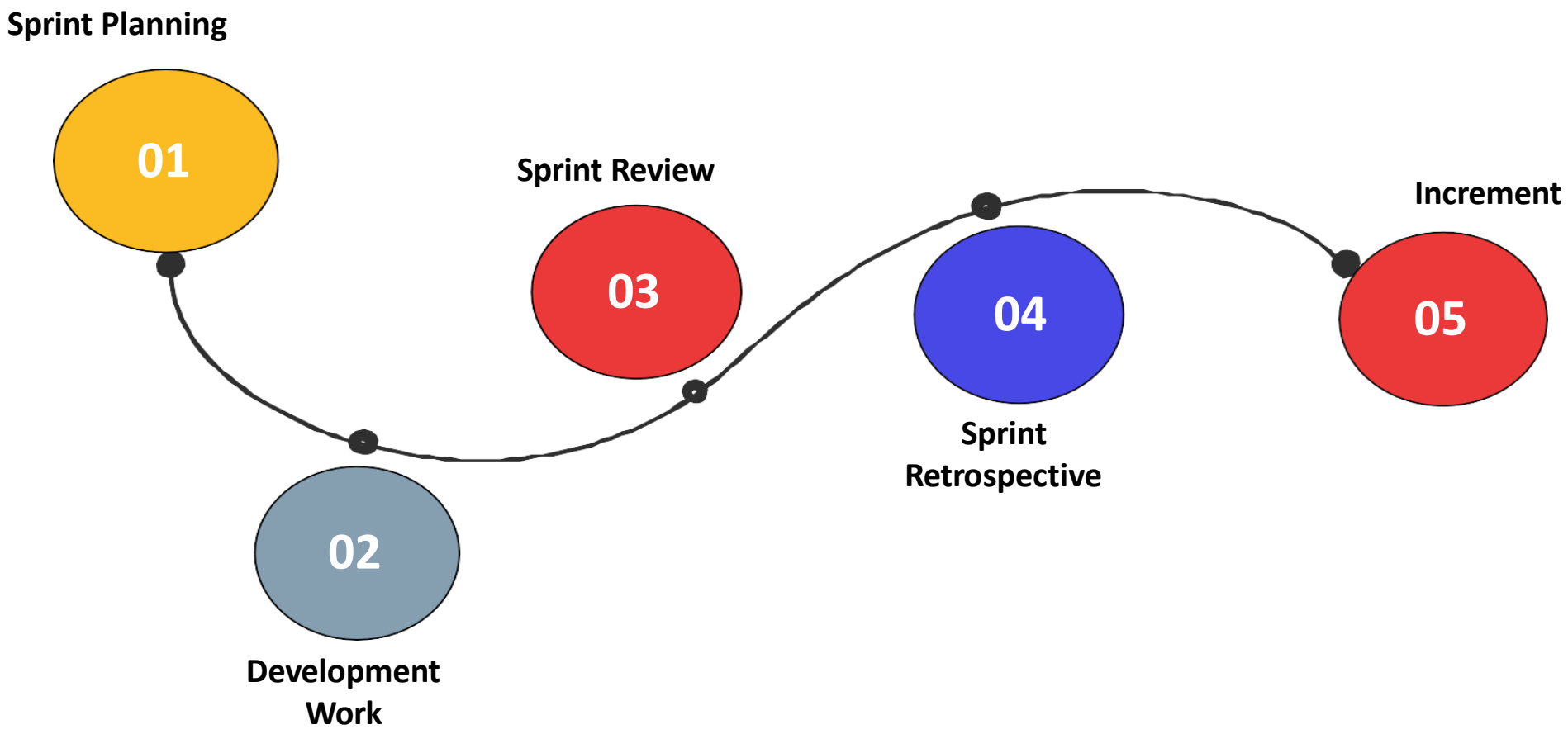
3. Sprint Review

This is a meeting at the end of the sprint where the team demonstrates the completed work to stakeholders. As the Product Owner, you provide feedback on the work completed during the sprint and ensure that it aligns with the product vision.

4. Sprint Retrospective

This is a meeting where the team reflects on the previous sprint and identifies ways to improve their processes. As the Product Owner, you attend this meeting to gain insights into the team's workflow and provide feedback on any issues that may impact the product.

Sprint Process



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Sprint Planning

- ✓ Sprint planning involves three stages of preparation:
- ✓ Capacity
  - Establishing the load factor, availability, holidays, and vacations
- ✓ Scope
  - Setting a sprint goal, taking stories from the top of the Product Backlog
- ✓ Estimation
  - Task breakdown and timescale
  - Task and story owner assignment
  - Estimate vs capacity
- ✓ Plan is created by the entire Scrum team
- ✓ The meeting is timeboxed, 8 hours being set aside for a month-long Sprint (proportioned appropriately for shorter Sprints)

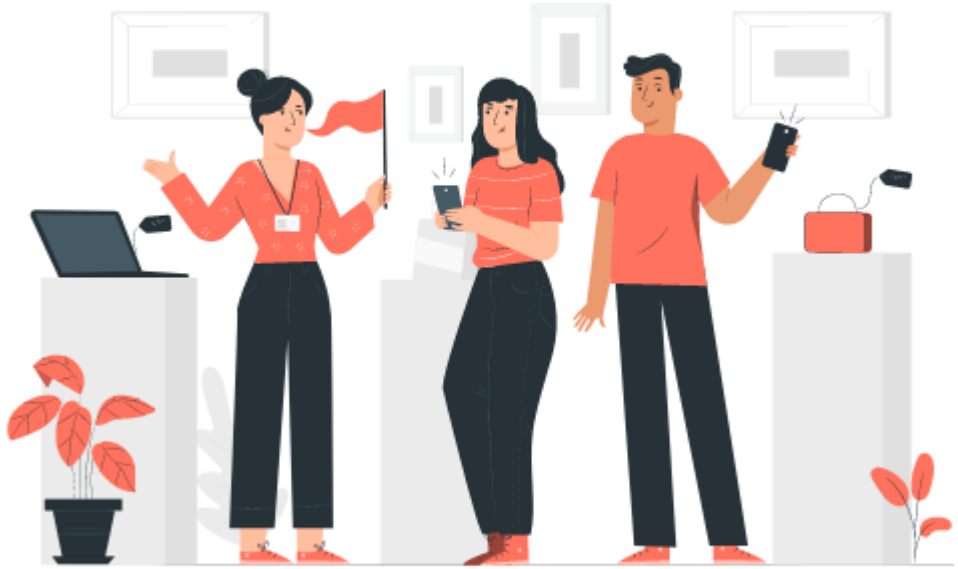
Sprint Planning

The meeting is divided into two parts:

- ✓ What will be delivered?
- ✓ How will it be achieved?

The Sprint Backlog

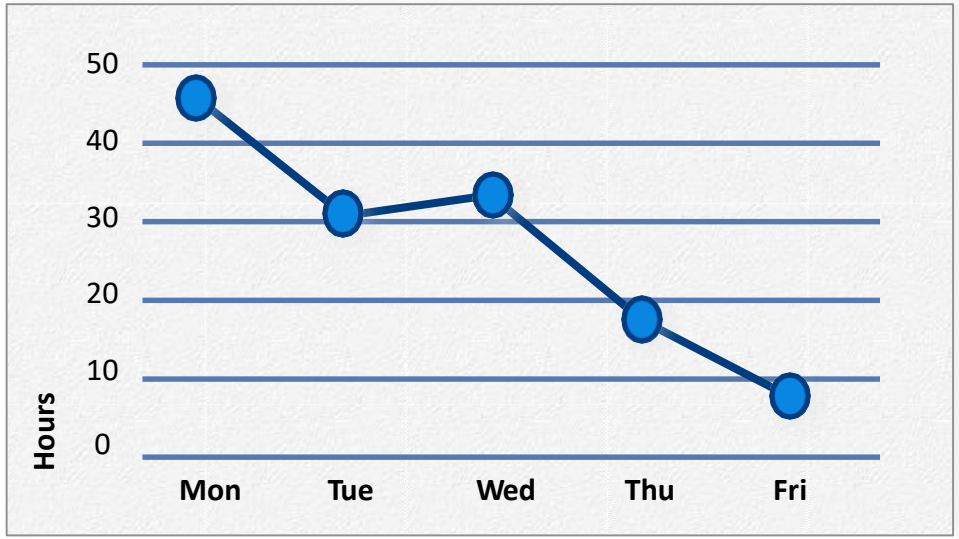
- ✓ The Sprint Backlog is the set of Product Backlog items selected for the Sprint, as well as the plan for delivery and realising the Spring Goal
- ✓ It forecasts the functionality of the increment to be delivered and the work required for it to be considered "Done"
- ✓ It is a visible representation of the work that the Development Team deems necessary for the Sprint Goal. It should have enough detail so that progress can be understood in the Daily Scrum
- ✓ The Spring Backlog is modified throughout the Sprint by the Development Team. If new work is acquired, it is added to the Sprint Backlog. Unnecessary elements are removed



Managing the SprintBacklog

- ✓ Key to Scrum is that individuals must sign up for work of their own choosing. Work is never assigned
- ✓ Estimated work remaining is updated daily. Communication is key
- ✓ Development Team members can add to, delete from, or change the sprint backlog
- ✓ If work is unclear, it should be defined with a larger amount of time and broken down later

Tasks	Mon	Tues	Wed	Thur	Fri
Code the user interface	8	4	8		
Code the middle tier	16	12	10	7	
Test the middle tier	8	16	16	11	8
Write online help	12				



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The Development Work

- ✓ Requirements are developed and tested as part of the development work
- ✓ Individuals sign up for work of their own choosing
- ✓ Work is never assigned
- ✓ Estimated work remaining is updated daily

Sprint Review

- ✓ A Sprint will culminate in a Sprint Review, which inspects and analyses the work completed during the Sprint (also known as an Increment – this will be explained later)
- ✓ Stakeholders invited by the Product Owner may also attend, in order to inspect the Scrum Team's progress
- ✓ The meeting should be timeboxed to a maximum of four hours for a Sprint of the longest duration (one month), and scaled accordingly for shorter Sprints
- ✓ The purpose of the Review is to provide feedback for the Sprint and enhance team cohesiveness going into the subsequent Sprint
- ✓ There is typically a demonstration of new features or underlying architecture
- ✓ During the Review, the Product Owner should explain what has been "Done" over the course of the Sprint
- ✓ The Scrum Team should also demonstrate the work that has been "Done", discuss the progress made during the Sprint, and field questions from stakeholders (or even other members of the Team)

Sprint Review

- ✓ The Review also provides a valuable opportunity for the Scrum Team to initially collaborate on the course of action for the next Sprint, though this is not finalised during the Review; instead, it provides valuable qualitative data to be processed in the planning meeting for the next Sprint.

The Sprint Review includes the following elements:

- ✓ The Product Owner explains what Product Backlog items have been "Done" and what has not
- ✓ The Development Team explains what went well during the Sprint, what problems they encountered, and how they solved those problems. They also demonstrate the work that it has "Done" and answers questions about the Increment
- ✓ The Product Owner discusses the current state of the Product Backlog and project's likely completion dates based on progress so far
- ✓ All collaborate on what to do next, so that the Sprint Review provides valuable input to subsequent Sprint Planning

Sprint Retrospective

- ✓ This is typically done after every Sprint and lasts around three hours
- ✓ The whole team participates, including the Scum Master, Product Owner, Team, potential customers, and other stakeholders
- ✓ Collaborate on next opportunity to optimise value. It inspects the last Sprint with regards to people, relationships, processes, and tools
- ✓ The Retrospective should culminate in a plan for implementing improvements during the following Sprint
- ✓ It may also be used to reconfigure relationship dynamics or tackle interpersonal conflicts to make sure that the next Sprint begins with the Scrum Team working as an effective unit

Sprint Retrospective

- ✓ The Sprint Retrospective is more introspective than the Review, focusing on internal relationships and progress rather than the outward-facing nature of the Review
- ✓ This dual approach should prepare the Scrum Team holistically for the planning meeting at the beginning of the following Sprint
- ✓ This is facilitated by the Scrum Master
- ✓ The Retrospective is timeboxed to a maximum of three hours by the Scrum Master. It should consider the success of the last Sprint through examining:
  - The status of internal and external Team relationships
  - The success of processes and tools used
  - Work items that were completed proficiently and areas for potential improvement

Increment

- ✓ The Increment is the sum of all the Product Backlog items completed during a Sprint and the value of the increments of all previous Sprints.
- ✓ At the end of a Sprint, the new Increment must be “Done,” meaning it must be in useable condition and meet the Scrum Team’s definition.
- ✓ The increment should be in a usable condition regardless of whether the Product Owner decides to actually release it.
- ✓ Development Teams deliver an Increment of functionality every Sprint. This Increment is useable, so a Product Owner may choose to immediately release it.

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How the Development Team and Product Owner Collaborate During the Sprint

Collaboration Activity	Product Owner's Role	Development Team's Role
Backlog Refinement	Prioritise the Product Backlog and collaborate with the Development Team to refine the requirements and estimate the effort needed to complete the items.	Collaborate with the Product Owner to understand the requirements of the items and provide input on the feasibility of completing them.
Sprint Planning	Define the Sprint Goal and select the items that will be worked on during the Sprint. Collaborate with the Development Team to determine the best approach to complete the items within the Sprint.	Collaborate with the Product Owner to understand the Sprint Goal and the requirements of the items selected for the Sprint.
Daily Scrum	Listen to the Development Team's progress updates and provide input on any issues that may impact the product.	Provide progress updates and identify any obstacles that may impact the completion of the Sprint Goal.
Sprint Review	Listen to the Development Team's progress updates and provide input on any issues that may impact the product.	Demonstrate the completed work to the Product Owner and provide insight into the work done.
Sprint Retrospective	Collaborate with the Development Team to identify opportunities for improvement in the development process. Provide feedback on the product backlog.	Provide feedback on the process used to complete the Sprint and identify areas for improvement.

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What is Team Commitment?

- ✓ Team commitment in Scrum refers to the level of dedication and focus that the team has towards achieving the sprint goals and delivering high-quality work.
- ✓ As the Product Owner, it is important to foster a strong sense of commitment within the team to ensure that everyone is working towards a common goal and is willing to go above and beyond to achieve it.
- ✓ To build team commitment, the Product Owner should work closely with the Development Team to establish clear sprint goals and a well-defined product backlog.
- ✓ The team should be involved in the planning and prioritisation of work, and the Product Owner should encourage open communication and collaboration throughout the process.
- ✓ The Product Owner should also provide the team with the necessary resources and support to help them achieve their goals.

Sustainable Pace

- ✓ In Scrum, sustainable pace refers to the team's ability to maintain a consistent level of productivity over time without overworking or burning out.
- ✓ As the Product Owner in Scrum, it is important to understand the concept of sustainable pace and work to ensure that the team is not overburdened with work or deadlines that are impossible to meet.
- ✓ A sustainable pace allows the team to maintain their productivity over time, reduce the risk of burnout, and ultimately deliver higher quality work.
- ✓ As the Product Owner, it is your responsibility to ensure that the team is able to work at a sustainable pace, which will lead to a more successful project and happier team members.

Sprints are Timeboxed and Protected

In Scrum, sprints are timeboxed and protected for several reasons:

01

Encourage Focus

02

Manage Expectations

03

Facilitate Planning and Prioritisation

04

Increase Accountability

05

Encourage Improvement

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Sprints are Timeboxed and Protected

- ✓ **Encourage Focus:** By having a defined timebox for the sprint, the team is encouraged to stay focused on delivering the sprint goal without getting sidetracked by other tasks or distractions.
- ✓ **Manage Expectations:** Timeboxing the sprint allows the Product Owner to manage stakeholder expectations by providing a clear timeframe for when certain features or functionalities will be delivered.
- ✓ **Facilitate Planning and Prioritisation:** Knowing that there is a set timeframe for the sprint, the team can plan and prioritise their work accordingly, which allows for more efficient use of time and resources.
- ✓ **Increase Accountability:** The timebox helps to create a sense of urgency and accountability within the team, which can help to increase productivity and motivation.
- ✓ **Encourage Improvement:** By having a defined timeframe for the sprint, the team is encouraged to continuously improve their processes and work to deliver higher quality work within each sprint.

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Module 8:
Release Management

- ✓ Release Management
- ✓ Goal of Release Management
- ✓ Planning is Iterative, Adaptable, and Participation
- ✓ Velocity
- ✓ Burn Down Charts and Scrum Boards
- ✓ Release Burndown
- ✓ Sprint Burndown

Release Management

- ✓ Scrum, release management is the process of planning, coordinating, and overseeing the delivery of new product increments or updates to customers or end-users
- ✓ As the Product Owner, it is your responsibility to manage the release process and ensure that new features or updates are delivered to customers in a timely and efficient manner

Release management in Scrum typically involves the following activities:

1. Release Planning
2. Sprint Reviews
3. Acceptance Testing
4. Deployment
5. Feedback and Continuous Improvement

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Goal of Release Management

- ✓ he goal of Release Management in Scrum is to ensure that the product developed by the Scrum team is delivered in a timely and efficient manner while meeting the customer's needs and expectations
- ✓ As the person responsible for the product, the Scrum Product Owner has the responsibility of managing the release process

Here are some of the specific goals of Release Management in Scrum for the Product Owner

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Goal of Release Management

- ✓ **Define Release Goals:** The Product Owner must define the goals of the release, including the scope, objectives, and timelines. This involves working closely with stakeholders to understand their requirements and expectations, and then defining a release plan that meets these needs

- ✓ **Prioritise the Backlog:** The Product Owner must prioritise the product backlog to ensure that the most valuable features are developed first. This involves working closely with stakeholders to understand their needs and priorities, and then prioritising the backlog accordingly

- ✓ **Monitor progress:** The Product Owner must monitor progress throughout the release to ensure that the team is on track to meet the release goals. This involves tracking progress using tools such as the Release Burndown chart, and working with the team to address any issues that arise

Goal of Release Management

- ✓ **Communicate with Stakeholders:** The Product Owner must communicate with stakeholders throughout the release to keep them informed of progress and to ensure that their needs are being met. This involves regular updates on progress, as well as seeking feedback from stakeholders to ensure that the release is meeting their needs and expectations

- ✓ **Deliver the Release:** The Product Owner must ensure that the release is delivered in a timely and efficient manner. This involves working with the development team to ensure that the product is of high quality, and working with stakeholders to ensure that they are prepared to receive and use the release

Planning is Iterative, Adaptable, and Participation

Iterative

- ✓ Release planning is an iterative process that involves a continuous cycle of reviewing and refining the product backlog, determining the scope of the release, and defining the release schedule
- ✓ The process is not a one-time event but is ongoing and should be adapted as new information becomes available

Planning is Iterative, Adaptable, and Participation

Adaptable

- ✓ Release planning is adaptable and designed to be flexible enough to accommodate changes in customer or end-user needs, business priorities, and market conditions
- ✓ The Product Owner should be prepared to adjust the release plan as needed to ensure that it continues to meet the needs of the customer or end-users and align with the overall product vision and business goals

Planning is Iterative, Adaptable, and Participation

Participation

- ✓ Release planning involves participation from the Product Owner, Development Team, and other stakeholders
- ✓ This collaboration is critical to ensuring that the release plan is aligned with the needs of the customer or end-users and that the Development Team has the necessary resources and support to complete the work

Velocity

1. Velocity is the speed at which teams get work done
2. A stable team means more accurate estimates of velocity
3. It is the sum of the estimates for work items completed successfully in an iteration
4. Optimum velocity is not necessarily maximum. Look at testing, defects, and other quality factors, as well as the speed at which the team works to determine optimum velocity
5. Velocity helps a Scrum Team to set realistic goals in planning iterations and releases
6. The product must not suffer
7. Velocity should be measured using the same units as your features (for example days, hours, and so on)

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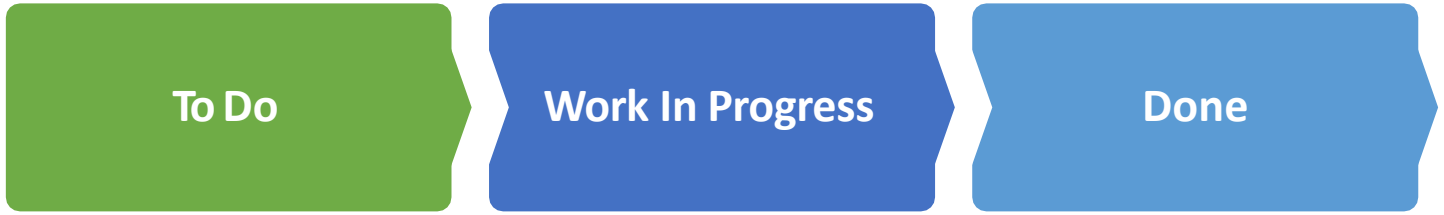
- The product must not suffer 13

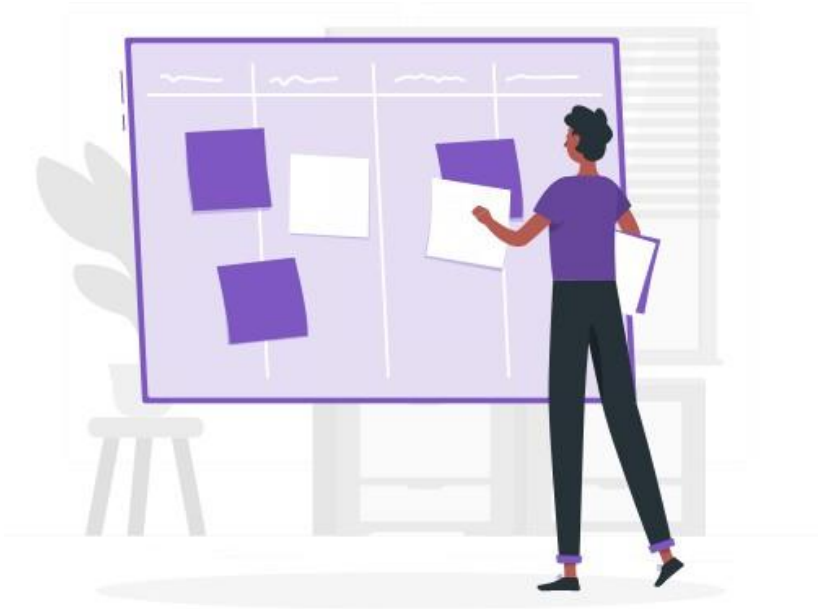
Burn Down Charts and Scrum Boards

- ✓ The burn down chart is a core project management tool in Scrum
- ✓ A graphical representation of work to do against time left, it focuses on how future time is spent
- ✓ Based on estimates, it gives an indication to the Product Owner of team commitment and is updated every sprint
- ✓ It can be used to train a team's estimations, as well as giving the project manager a means for tracking their progress
- ✓ **A scrum board is normally divided into three categories:**



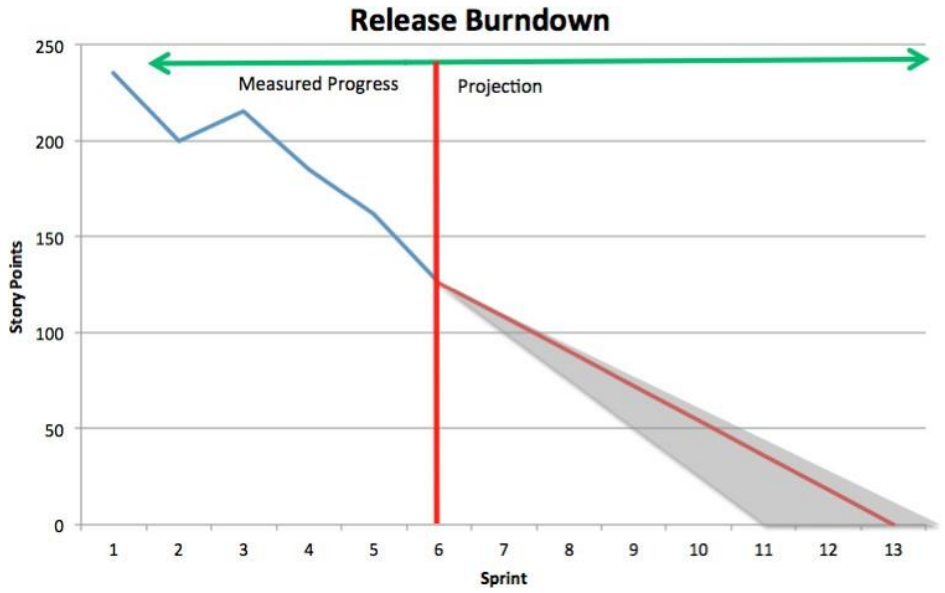
Burn Down Charts and Scrum Boards

- ✓ However, a team may decide to add a Testing/Verify category depending on needs
- ✓ During Scrum Planning, User Stories are moved from the Backlog to the board as a task (written on a post-it if a physical board)
- ✓ Team members choose a task to complete and move it to the “In Progress” column
- ✓ Upon completion, the task is then moved to the “Verify” or “Done” category



Release Burndown

- ✓ The Release Burndown chart is a tool used by the Scrum Product Owner to track the progress of the product development team towards achieving the goals of a specific release
- ✓ It is a graphical representation that shows how much work is remaining in the release backlog over time, and it is updated daily during the Sprint



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Release Burndown

The Release Burndown chart is useful for the Product Owner because it allows them to:

01 Track Progress Towards the Release Goals

02 Identify and Address Potential Issues Early

03 Communicate Progress to Stakeholders

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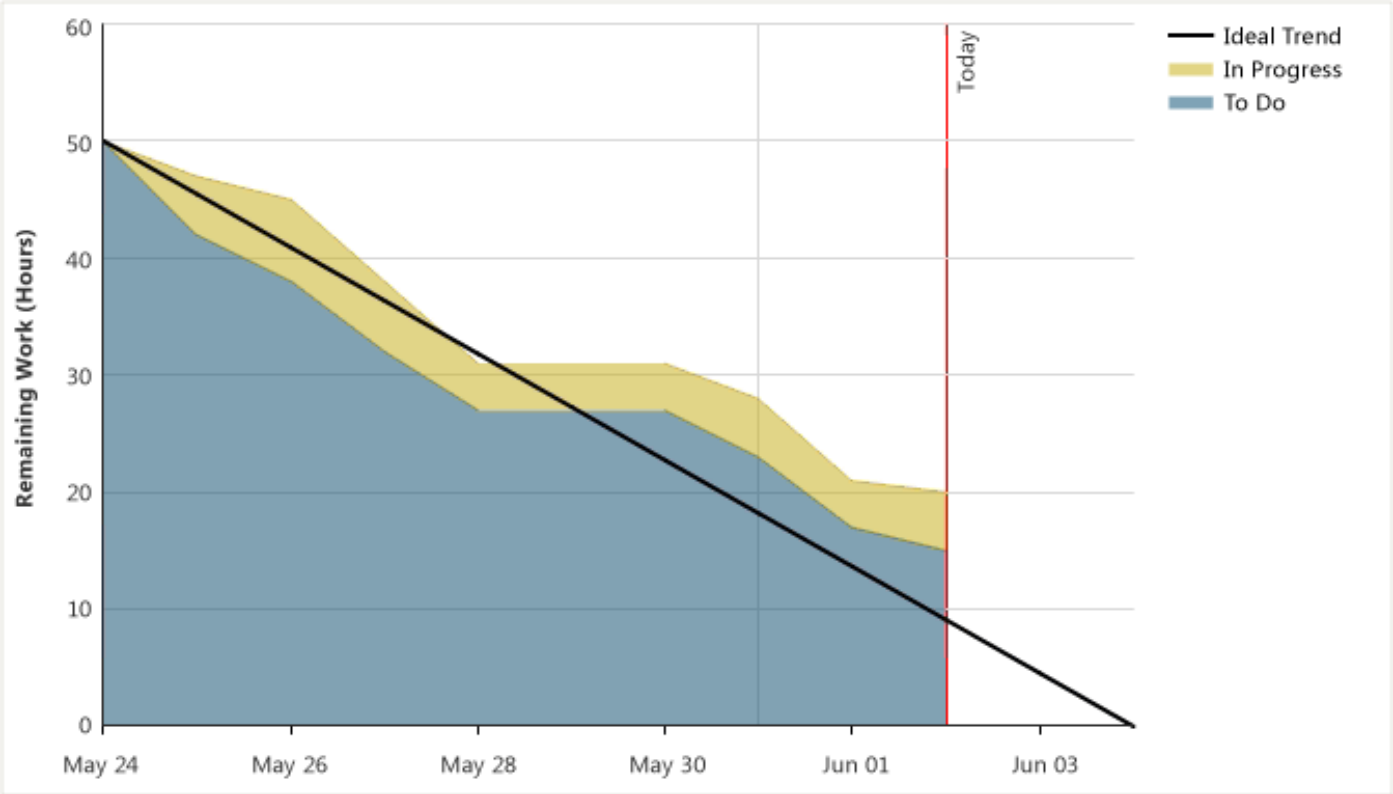
Release Burndown

1. **Track Progress Towards the Release Goals:** The Release Burndown chart provides a clear and easy-to-understand visualisation of how much work is remaining in the release backlog, and how quickly it is being completed. This helps the Product Owner track progress towards the release goals and make informed decisions about how to adjust the backlog and team's work during the Sprint.

2. **Identify and Address Potential Issues Early:** By regularly reviewing the Release Burndown chart, the Product Owner can identify potential issues early and take appropriate action. For example, if the chart shows that the team is not making progress as quickly as expected, the Product Owner can investigate the cause and take steps to address it, such as reprioritising the backlog or adjusting the team's work.

3. **Communicate Progress to Stakeholders:** The Release Burndown chart can also be used to communicate progress to stakeholders, such as customers or executives. By sharing the chart with stakeholders, the Product Owner can demonstrate how the team is making progress towards the release goals and provide transparency into the development process.

Release Burndown



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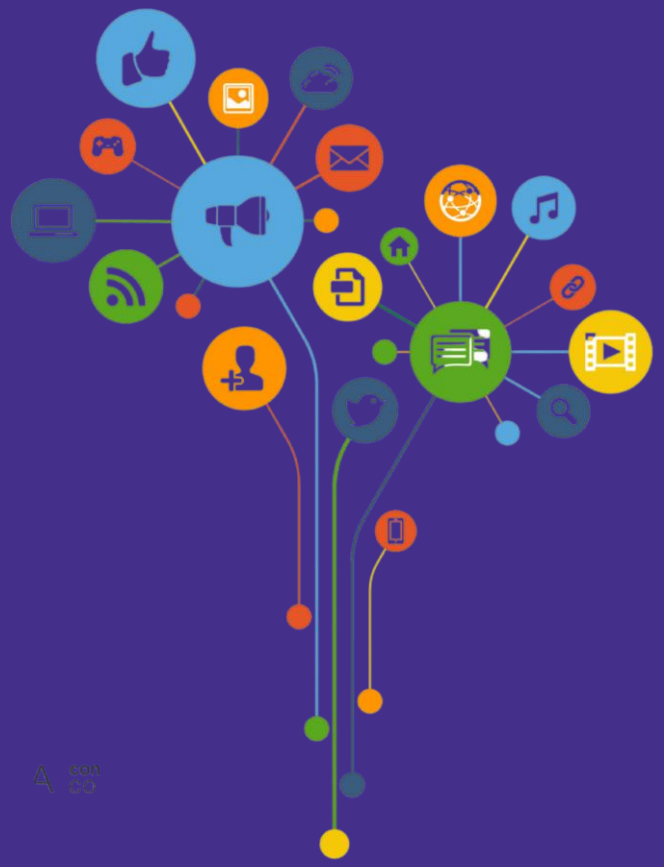

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